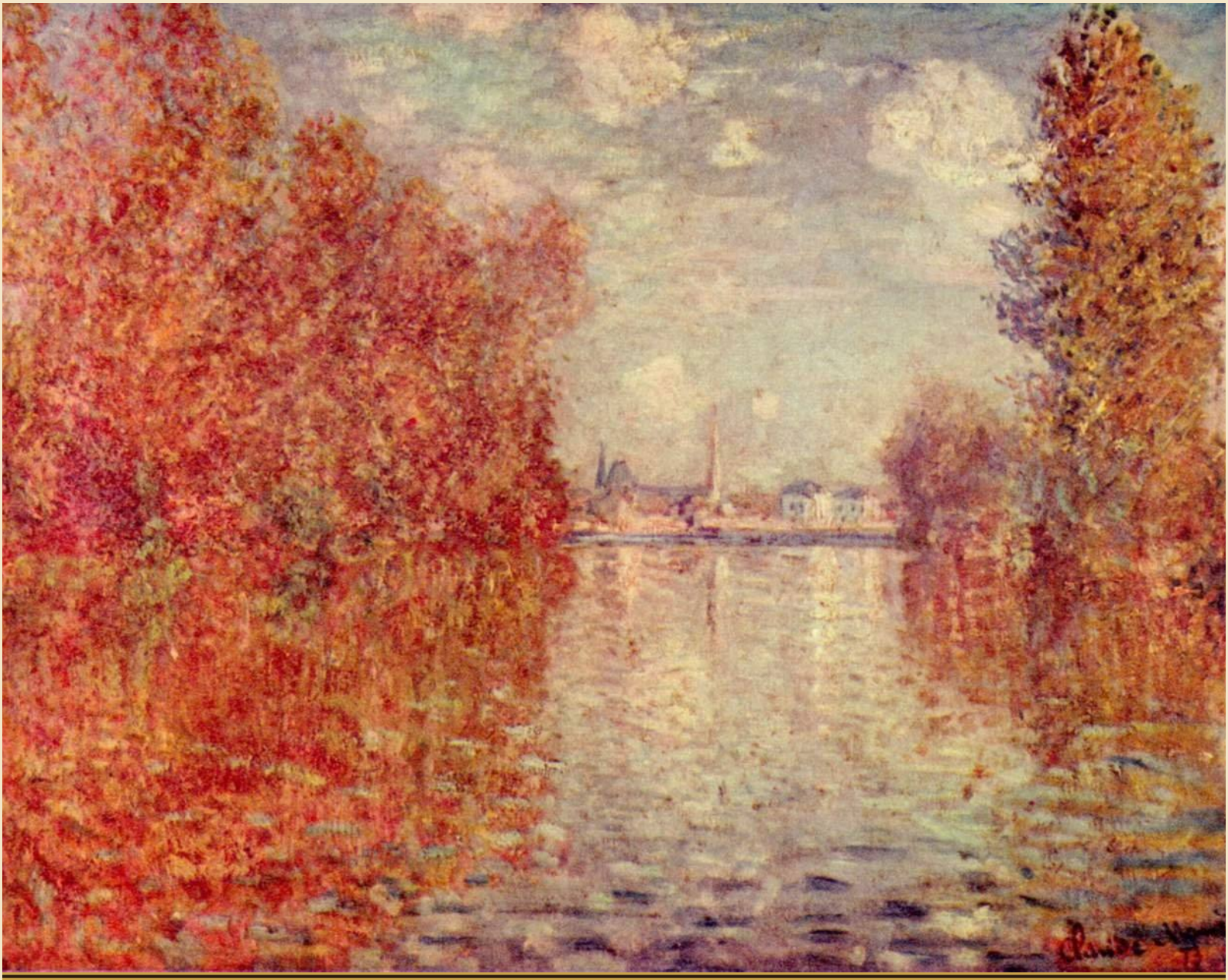


Siddhartha

Hermann Hesse · 1922

English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets (Project Gutenberg #2500; Standard Ebooks edition)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Indiana 2023 edition (standards shown for this framework only)

12 chapter lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 16 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 4 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Cover: Claude Monet, Autumn at Argenteuil (1873). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–12), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Translated from the German by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets for Project Gutenberg (ebook #2500); this text is the Standard Ebooks edition, believed to be in the U.S. public domain, with Standard Ebooks' own contributions dedicated under CC0 1.0. Word-choice analysis studies the translators' English, not Hesse's German.

Content note for teachers: Cultural representation: Siddhartha is a German novelist's adaptation of Hindu and Buddhist ideas, not a sacred or authoritative text. Discuss whose perspective shapes the story, and frame the caste system as a system of harm.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 4. **Class days:** 16 × 90 minutes (12 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Siddhartha suggest about the search for self-knowledge?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about experience versus teaching?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the unity of all things?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the river and time?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about love and attachment?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Indiana 2023

7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1

Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five

Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.

Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Son of the Brahmin With the Samanas Gotama Awakening	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the search for self-knowledge* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Kamala *Socratic seminar on the search for self-knowledge* With the Childlike People Sansara By the River	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*experience versus teaching* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the search for self-knowledge • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	The Ferryman The Son Om Govinda *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the unity of all things* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay
4	*Final essay workshop and submission*	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*the river and time* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Siddhartha

Author biography

Hermann Hesse was born on 2 July 1877 in Calw, in the German kingdom of Württemberg, into a family of Pietist Protestant missionaries with deep ties to India: his father, Johannes Hesse, had served with the Basel Mission there, his mother, Marie Gundert, was born in India, and his grandfather Hermann Gundert was a missionary scholar of Malayalam. As a teenager Hesse ran away from the Protestant seminary at Maulbronn and went through a severe personal crisis before training as a bookseller in Tübingen and Basel. His first success, Peter Camenzind (1904), let him live as a writer. During the First World War he published an appeal against nationalist hatred and was denounced in the German press; after the war, amid a breakdown of his marriage and his health, he moved to Montagnola in Switzerland and became a Swiss citizen in 1924. His major novels include Demian (1919), Siddhartha (1922), Steppenwolf (1927) and The Glass Bead Game (1943). He received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1946 and died in Montagnola on 9 August 1962.

Historical and cultural context

Siddhartha is set in India in the time of the Buddha (around the fifth century BCE), but it was written in Europe just after the First World War, when many young Germans had lost faith in the nation, the church and their parents' certainties. Hesse had grown up among books and stories about India, travelled in 1911 to Ceylon (Sri Lanka), Malaya and Sumatra, and read the Upanishads, the Bhagavad Gita and Buddhist texts in translation. He was also influenced by psychoanalysis; he underwent analysis with a follower of Carl Jung around 1916–17. The novel is a European writer's imagined India: it uses Hindu and Buddhist ideas (Atman, Brahman, the Samanas, nirvana, Om, the cycle of Sansara) to tell a very personal story about finding one's own way.

Publication and reception, then and now

Hesse wrote the first part in 1919–20, then stopped for about a year and a half because, as he later explained, he could not write about a stage of experience he had not yet lived. The book appeared in 1922 from S. Fischer Verlag in Berlin, subtitled "an Indian poem"; the first part is dedicated to the French writer Romain Rolland and the second to Hesse's cousin Wilhelm Gundert, a scholar of Japan. An English translation by Hilda Rosner was published in the United States by New Directions in 1951.

Then: In Germany in the 1920s the book was respected but not one of Hesse's bestsellers; readers knew him better for Demian. Some critics found its Indian setting exotic decoration for a European story of the self.

Now: Siddhartha became a worldwide success after the 1951 English translation, especially in the 1960s, when the American counterculture embraced Hesse as a prophet of self-discovery and Eastern spirituality. It is now one of the most widely translated German novels and is taught in world literature and philosophy classes. Scholars today also discuss its limits: it is a Western, idealized picture of Indian religion, and its hero is not the Buddha but a seeker who rejects every teacher, including the Buddha.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Siddhartha, the gifted son of a Brahmin priest, leaves home with his friend Govinda to search for the truth about the self. He tries the life of the wandering ascetics, meets the Buddha, enters the world of a great city and a beautiful courtesan, and finally comes to a river and a ferryman. The book follows one man's whole life as he tests every path to wisdom.

Main themes

- the search for the self: what Siddhartha is looking for, and why no teacher can hand it to him.
- teaching versus experience: Siddhartha learns from every person he meets but follows no one; ask what he learns and how.
- the river and time: the river becomes a teacher; watch how it is described each time it appears.
- love and attachment: from friendship to the senses to a father's love; what does each kind of love teach him?
- unity of opposites: life and death, sin and holiness, stone and Buddha; the book's ending holds them together.

Why it matters

Students are at the age when Siddhartha leaves home, and the novel asks their questions: can you learn wisdom from teachers, or must you live it? It also lets classes examine how a Western writer imagined India, a useful lesson in reading cultural representation critically.

Spoilers · teacher only

Siddhartha rejects the Buddha's teaching (though he reveres him), learns love from Kamala and business from Kamaswami, grows rich and empty, nearly drowns himself, and is renewed by the river. He becomes Vasudeva's fellow ferryman, meets Kamala again as she dies, and loses his son, who runs away. Listening to the river he hears the unity of all voices in Om; in old age he tells Govinda that wisdom cannot be taught, and Govinda sees all things in his face.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Siddhartha: Think of the best teacher you have had. Could they have taught you everything you need to know about life? Why or why not?*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Siddhartha: Think of the best teacher you have had. Could they have taught you everything you need to know about life? Why or why not?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

Brahmin (the priestly class in Hindu society); Atman (the self or soul); Brahman (ultimate reality); Samana (a wandering ascetic); Om (a sacred syllable); nirvana (release from the cycle of suffering and rebirth); Sansara (the cycle of birth, death and desire); Gotama (Siddhartha Gautama, the Buddha).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Hermann Hesse was born on 2 July 1877 in Calw, in the German kingdom of Württemberg, into a family of Pietist Protestant missionaries with deep ties to India: his father, Johannes Hesse, had served with the Basel Mission there, his mother, Marie Gundert, was born in India, and his grandfather Hermann Gundert was a missionary scholar of Malayalam. As a teenager Hesse ran away from the Protestant seminary at Maulbronn and went through a severe personal crisis before training as a bookseller in Tübingen and Basel. His first success, Peter Camenzind (1904), let him live as a writer. During the First World War he published an appeal against nationalist hatred and was denounced in the German press; after the war, amid a breakdown of his marriage and his health, he moved to Montagnola in Switzerland and became a Swiss citizen in 1924. His major novels include Demian (1919), Siddhartha (1922), Steppenwolf (1927) and The Glass Bead Game (1943). He received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1946 and died in Montagnola on 9 August 1962. The world of the book. Siddhartha is set in India in the time of the Buddha (around the fifth century BCE), but it was written in Europe just after the First World War, when many young Germans had lost faith in the nation, the church and their parents' certainties. Hesse had grown up among books and stories about India, travelled in 1911 to Ceylon (Sri Lanka), Malaya and Sumatra, and read the Upanishads, the Bhagavad Gita and Buddhist texts in translation. He was also influenced by psychoanalysis; he underwent analysis with a follower of Carl Jung around 1916–17. The novel is a European writer's imagined India: it uses Hindu and Buddhist ideas (Atman, Brahman, the Samanas, nirvana, Om, the cycle of Sansara) to tell a very personal story about finding one's own way. Publication and reception. Hesse wrote the first part in 1919–20, then stopped for about a year and a half because, as he later explained, he could not write about a stage of experience he had not yet lived. The book appeared in 1922 from S. Fischer Verlag in Berlin, subtitled "an Indian poem"; the first part is dedicated to the French writer Romain Rolland and the second to Hesse's cousin Wilhelm Gundert, a scholar of Japan. An English translation by Hilda Rosner was published in the United States by New Directions in 1951. Then: In Germany in the 1920s the book was respected but not one of Hesse's bestsellers; readers knew him better for Demian. Some critics found its Indian setting exotic decoration for a European story of the self. Now: Siddhartha became a worldwide success after the 1951 English translation, especially in the 1960s, when the American counterculture embraced Hesse as a prophet of self-discovery and Eastern spirituality. It is now one of the most widely translated German novels and is taught in world literature and philosophy classes. Scholars today also discuss its limits: it is a Western, idealized picture of Indian religion, and its hero is not the Buddha but a seeker who rejects every teacher, including the Buddha.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"In the shade of the house, in the sunshine of the riverbank near the boats, in the shade of the Sal-wood forest, in the shade of the fig tree is where Siddhartha grew up" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 1). The novel's opening sentence: rhythmic, repetitive, almost like chant. The river appears in the first line, before we know it will matter.

> *In the shade of the house, in the sunshine of the riverbank near the boats, in the shade of the Sal-wood forest, in the shade of the fig tree is where Siddhartha grew up (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: "In the shade of the house, in the sunshine of the riverbank near the boats, in the shade of the Sal-wood forest, in the shade of the fig tree is where Siddhartha grew up" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 1). The novel's opening sentence: rhythmic, repetitive, almost like chant. The river appears in the first line, before we know it will matter.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): Siddhartha, the gifted son of a Brahmin priest, leaves home with his friend Govinda to search for the truth about the self. He tries the life of the wandering ascetics, meets the Buddha, enters the world of a great city and a beautiful courtesan, and finally comes to a river and a ferryman. The book follows one man's whole life as he tests every path to wisdom. Themes to track: the search for the self: what Siddhartha is looking for, and why no teacher can hand it to him. teaching versus experience: Siddhartha learns from every person he meets but follows no one; ask what he learns and how. the river and time: the river becomes a teacher; watch how it is described each time it appears. love and attachment: from friendship to the senses to a father's love; what does each kind of love teach him? unity of opposites: life and death, sin and holiness, stone and Buddha; the book's ending holds them together.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "teaching versus experience": Prediction: Siddhartha will reject his teachers. Question: will he ever find someone he can learn from?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Siddhartha: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "teaching versus experience": Prediction: Siddhartha will reject his teachers. Question: will he ever find someone he can learn from?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Siddhartha still matter? Students are at the age when Siddhartha leaves home, and the novel asks their questions: can you learn wisdom from teachers, or must you live it? It also lets classes examine how a Western writer imagined India, a useful lesson in reading cultural representation critically.
Anchor question: Why might Siddhartha still be taught today?
Facilitation: Students are at the age when Siddhartha leaves home, and the novel asks their questions: can you learn wisdom from teachers, or must you live it? It also lets classes examine how a Western writer imagined India, a useful lesson in reading cultural representation critically.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Name one fact about Hesse's life or times that helps explain why he wrote a novel about a young man who leaves his father's religion. Answer: Examples: Hesse ran away from a religious seminary; his parents were missionaries; he wrote after the First World War, when many young Germans had lost faith in old authorities.
Exit ticket: Name one fact about Hesse's life or times that helps explain why he wrote a novel about a young man who leaves his father's religion.
Answer: Examples: Hesse ran away from a religious seminary; his parents were missionaries; he wrote after the First World War, when many young Germans had lost faith in old authorities.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: The Son of the Brahmin.

Teacher notes · sources: Nobel Prize, "Hermann Hesse: Biographical" (https://www.nobelprize.org/prizes/literature/1946/hesse/biographical/); Britannica, "Hermann Hesse" and "Siddhartha" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Hermann-Hesse); Theodore Ziolkowski, The Novels of Hermann Hesse (Princeton, 1965) (https://press.princeton.edu/); New Directions, publication history of the Hilda Rosner translation (https://www.ndbooks.com/book/siddhartha/); Project Gutenberg #2500 (reading text) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/2500)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Accounts of Hesse's analysis differ in detail: he saw the Jungian analyst Josef Bernhard Lang from 1916; he also met Jung. Say "a follower of Jung" unless you have checked a biography.
- The length of the writing pause (about eighteen months) comes from Hesse's own later statements and his letters; present it as his account.
- Sales figures for the 1960s boom vary widely by source; do not quote a number.

Lesson 2: The Son of the Brahmin

Focus: restlessness despite privilege

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha, a gifted Brahmin's son loved by everyone, including his devoted friend Govinda, feels that the teachings and rituals of his elders have not given him inner peace. He asks his father for permission to join the wandering ascetics called Samanas; his father refuses, but Siddhartha stands silently all night until his father consents. Govinda goes with him.

Background: Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of injustice, not a neutral backdrop. the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I.

Significance: The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the search for the self because....*
> **Prompt:** Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the search for the self because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: ablution — a ritual washing of the body; focused — fixed; concentrated (on a target); ascetics — people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons; pristine — completely free from dirt or contamination; invocation — a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service.*
> **Words:** ablution: a ritual washing of the body · focused: fixed; concentrated (on a target) · ascetics: people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons · pristine: completely free from dirt or contamination · invocation: a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of injustice, not a neutral backdrop. the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I. The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living. Setting: The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered. Characterization: Everyone loves Siddhartha (his father, mother, the girls, Govinda), yet he is discontented. Hesse makes his restlessness more striking by giving him everything. Conflict: The son's will against the father's: the scene of Siddhartha standing all night until his father relents is a quiet, total conflict. Watch for the river: present in the very first sentence, unremarked; later it becomes the novel's central symbol.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8). The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. That is setting at work: The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered.

> *Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8). The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. That is setting at work: The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The repetition "where, where" shows urgency; "innermost" and "ultimate" show he seeks something deeper than ritual. This connects to the search for the self. Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self? Expected: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. (The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis.)

> *But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The repetition "where, where" shows urgency; "innermost" and "ultimate" show he seeks something deeper than ritual. This connects to the search for the self.
Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self?
Expected answer: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. (The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about restlessness despite privilege? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. When the text says “Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He "had started to nurse discontent in himself" despite universal love and asks "where, where was this Self," a question his father's rituals cannot answer.

Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about restlessness despite privilege? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. When the text says “Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He "had started to nurse discontent in himself" despite universal love and asks "where, where was this Self," a question his father's rituals cannot answer.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful? Ask: is Siddhartha selfish to leave his parents? Let students argue both ways with lines from the father scene.

Anchor question: Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?

Facilitation: Ask: is Siddhartha selfish to leave his parents? Let students argue both ways with lines from the father scene.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about restlessness despite privilege? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. ("Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself", The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about restlessness despite privilege? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. ("Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself", The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes restlessness despite privilege. Key takeaway: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered.
- **Characterization:** Everyone loves Siddhartha (his father, mother, the girls, Govinda), yet he is discontented. Hesse makes his restlessness more striking by giving him everything.
- **Conflict:** The son's will against the father's: the scene of Siddhartha standing all night until his father relents is a quiet, total conflict.

Themes and how they develop

- **the search for the self:** Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it.

Symbols and motifs

- **the river:** present in the very first sentence, unremarked; later it becomes the novel's central symbol.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8) The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion.

- "But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8) The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis.
- "Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17) He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks.
Evidence: "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8)
Reasoning: He "had started to nurse discontent in himself" despite universal love and asks "where, where was this Self," a question his father's rituals cannot answer.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
ablution (noun)	a ritual washing of the body	*The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
focused (verb)	fixed; concentrated (on a target)	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ascetics (noun)	people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons	*I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pristine (adjective)	completely free from dirt or contamination	*Was not Atman in him, did not the pristine source spring from his heart?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invocation (noun)	a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service	*The sacrifices and the invocation of the gods were excellent —but was that all?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
protruding (verb)	extend out or project in space	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
partaking (verb)	have some of the qualities or attributes of something	*For a long time, Siddhartha had been partaking in the discussions of the wise men, practising debate with Govinda, practising with Govinda the art of reflection, the service of meditation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wavered (verb)	pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness	*Siddhartha wavered to the side, as he tried to walk.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

crouched (verb)	bend one's back forward from the waist on down	*As he slowly left on stiff legs in the first light of day the still quiet town, a shadow rose near the last hut, who had crouched there, and joined the pilgrim—Govinda.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
merciless (adjective)	having or showing no mercy	*Behind them blew a hot scent of quiet passion, of destructive service, of merciless self-denial.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is Siddhartha's family background? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is the son of a Brahmin
2. Who is Siddhartha's closest friend? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Govinda
3. Whom does Siddhartha want to join? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The Samanas
4. How does Siddhartha win his father's permission? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: By standing silently all night
5. What does Siddhartha seek that rituals have not given him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Inner peace and knowledge of Atman
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Son of the Brahmin” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha, a gifted Brahmin's son loved by everyone, including his devoted friend Govinda, feels that the teachings and rituals of his elders have not given him inner peace. He asks his father for permission to join the wandering ascetics called Samanas; his father refuses, but Siddhartha stands silently all night until his father consents. Govinda goes with him.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Son of the Brahmin”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Son of the Brahmin” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

9. Reread: “The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution.” What does “ablution” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: ablution: a ritual washing of the body.
10. Reread: “Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.” What does “focused” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: focused: fixed; concentrated (on a target).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Son of the Brahmin” suggest about restlessness despite privilege? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about restlessness despite privilege? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. On setting: The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Son of the Brahmin”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha, a gifted Brahmin's son loved by everyone, including his devoted friend Govinda, feels that the teachings and rituals of his elders have not given him inner peace. He asks his father for permission to join the wandering ascetics called Samanas; his father refuses, but Siddhartha stands…
6. As the opening chapter, what does “The Son of the Brahmin” set up that the rest of Siddhartha will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17): He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached. On characterization: Everyone loves Siddhartha (his father, mother, the girls, Govinda), yet he is discontented. Hesse makes his restlessness more striking by giving him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of… How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis. On setting: The opening is a lush, ordered world: the riverbank, the fig tree, the Brahmins' rituals. Repetition ("in the shade of") makes it feel timeless and sheltered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17): He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the

Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. On characterization: Everyone loves Siddhartha (his father, mother, the girls, Govinda), yet he is discontented. Hesse makes his restlessness more striking by giving him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Son of the Brahmin" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about restlessness despite privilege? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: "But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "The Son of the Brahmin": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: "Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17): He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: "Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis. On characterization: Everyone loves Siddhartha (his father, mother, the girls, Govinda), yet he is discontented. Hesse makes his restlessness more striking by giving him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Son of the Brahmin” treats restlessness despite privilege with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17): He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “With the Samanas” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Siddhartha had started to nurse discontent in himself” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The turning point of the chapter: discontent, not rebellion. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about restlessness despite privilege? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “But where, where was this self, this innermost part, this ultimate part” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8): The question that drives the whole novel, repeated for emphasis. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks. Useful evidence: “Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17): He speaks of himself in the third person, as if already detached. Theme link: Siddhartha asks where the

Atman, the innermost self, can be found, and sees that the rituals and teachers have not found it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. Who is Siddhartha's closest friend?
   A. Govinda
   B. Gotama
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Vasudeva
3. Whom does Siddhartha want to join?
   A. The soldiers
   B. The Brahmin priests
   C. The Samanas
   D. The merchants
4. How does Siddhartha win his father's permission?
   A. By arguing loudly
   B. By fasting for a month
   C. By standing silently all night
   D. By running away
5. What does Siddhartha seek that rituals have not given him?
   A. Wealth
   B. Fame
   C. A wife
   D. Inner peace and knowledge of Atman
6. In the line “The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution.”, what does “ablution” most nearly mean?
   A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons

B. fixed; concentrated (on a target)

C. a ritual washing of the body

D. completely free from dirt or contamination

7. In the line “Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.”, what does “focused” most nearly mean?

A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons

B. fixed; concentrated (on a target)

C. a ritual washing of the body

D. completely free from dirt or contamination

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. A (Govinda); 3. C (The Samanas); 4. C (By standing silently all night); 5. D (Inner peace and knowledge of Atman); 6. C (a ritual washing of the body); 7. B (fixed; concentrated (on a target))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Son of the Brahmin,” how does Hesse show restlessness despite privilege? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Son of the Brahmin, how does Hesse develop the idea of restlessness despite privilege? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of The Son of the Brahmin (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of restlessness despite privilege. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what The Son of the Brahmin suggests about restlessness despite privilege. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son of the Brahmin to complicate the reader's understanding of restlessness despite privilege. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate The Son of the Brahmin within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of restlessness despite privilege responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read The Son of the Brahmin alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of restlessness despite privilege follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Son of the Brahmin and its treatment of restlessness despite privilege. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Son of the Brahmin as evidence for a larger claim about restlessness despite privilege in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Son of the Brahmin as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of restlessness despite privilege. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ascetics” most nearly mean?

   A. bend one's back forward from the waist on down

   B. having or showing no mercy

   C. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons

   D. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness

2. *After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose. The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution. He called Siddhartha’s name. Siddhartha did not answer. Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe. Thus sat he, wrapped up in contemplation, thinking Om, his soul sent after the Brahman as an arrow.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Son of the Brahmin"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. Learning from the river

C. Detachment among the childlike people

D. Restlessness despite privilege

SAT key: 1. C (people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons); 2. D (Restlessness despite privilege)

Lesson 3: With the Samanas

Focus: self-denial as a path

Teacher only · spoilers

With the Samanas, Siddhartha learns fasting, enduring pain, and meditations that let his self pass into animals and objects. Yet after three years he concludes these are only escapes from the self, not true release. When rumors spread of Gotama, the Buddha, he and Govinda leave; Siddhartha masters the old Samana with his gaze before departing.

Background: Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India.

Significance: Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to teaching versus experience because....*
> **Prompt:** Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to teaching versus experience because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: numbing — a dulling of feeling or pain; nirvana — in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering; festering — infected and full of pus; cowered — crouch or curl up; numbness — partial or total lack of sensation in a part of the body; a symptom of nerve damage or dysfunction. “nirvana”: From Sanskrit nirvana "extinction," literally "a blowing out," from nir- "out" + va- "to blow."*
> **Words:** numbing: a dulling of feeling or pain · nirvana: in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering · festering: infected and full of pus · cowered: crouch or curl up · numbness: partial or total lack of sensation in a part of the body; a symptom of nerve damage or dysfunction

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India. Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest. Characterization: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself. Structure: Three years pass in a few pages; the chapter turns when rumours of Gotama arrive. Imagery: The heron, the dead jackal: Siddhartha "becomes" animals, vivid and strange. Watch for the river: The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and" (With the Samanas, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow" (With the Samanas, paragraph 3). The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. That is characterization at work: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself.

> *to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow (With the Samanas, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow" (With the Samanas, paragraph 3). The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. That is characterization at work: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The repeated "empty" shows the Samanas aim at nothing; Siddhartha later sees that emptiness is not knowledge. This links to teaching versus experience. Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience? Expected: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. (His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's.)

> *What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means (With the Samanas, paragraph 11)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The repeated "empty" shows the Samanas aim at nothing; Siddhartha later sees that emptiness is not knowledge. This links to teaching versus experience.
Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience?
Expected answer: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. (His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about self-denial as a path? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. When the text says "What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means" (With the Samanas, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He says what he learned "I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means," because meditation, like drink, only provides a temporary escape.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about self-denial as a path? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. When the text says "What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means" (With the Samanas, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He says what he learned "I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means," because meditation, like drink, only provides a temporary escape.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree? Ask: is the Samanas' path really like a drunkard's? Where does the comparison fail?

Anchor question: Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?

Facilitation: Ask: is the Samanas' path really like a drunkard's? Where does the comparison fail?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about self-denial as a path? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. ("What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means", With the Samanas, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about self-denial as a path? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. ("What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means", With the Samanas, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes self-denial as a path. Key takeaway: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself.
- **Structure:** Three years pass in a few pages; the chapter turns when rumours of Gotama arrive.
- **Imagery:** The heron, the dead jackal: Siddhartha "becomes" animals, vivid and strange.

Themes and how they develop

- **teaching versus experience:** Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape.

Symbols and motifs

- **the river:** The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and" (With the Samanas, paragraph 4).
- **teachers and teachings:** Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "Siddhartha sat upright and learned to breathe sparingly, learned to get along with only few breaths" (With the Samanas, paragraph 5).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow" (With the Samanas, paragraph 3) The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition.
- "A heron flew over the bamboo forest" (With the Samanas, paragraph 6) The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life.
- "What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means" (With the Samanas, paragraph 11) His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it.
Evidence: "What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means" (With the Samanas, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: He says what he learned "I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means," because meditation, like drink, only provides a temporary escape.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
numbing (noun)	a dulling of feeling or pain	*It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nirvana (noun)	in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering	*And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.*	"nirvana": From Sanskrit nirvana "extinction," literally "a blowing out," from nir- "out" + va- "to blow." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/nirvana)
festering (adjective)	infected and full of pus	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cowered (verb)	crouch or curl up	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

numbness (noun)	partial or total lack of sensation in a part of the body; a symptom of nerve damage or dysfunction	*We find comfort, we find numbness, we learn feats, to deceive others.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thirsted (verb)	longed for something strongly	*I always thirsted for knowledge, I have always been full of questions.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
breaths (noun)	the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing	*Siddhartha sat upright and learned to breathe sparingly, learned to get along with only few breaths, learned to stop breathing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
submerged (verb)	sink below the surface; go under or as if under water	*He possessed, so the believers said, the highest enlightenment, he remembered his previous lives, he had reached the nirvana and never returned into the cycle, was never again submerged in the murky river of physical forms.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mumbled (verb)	talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice	*And Govinda mumbled a verse to himself, a verse from an Upanishad:*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
meditate (verb)	reflect deeply on a subject	*He'll turn seventy and eighty, and you and me, we will grow just as old and will do our exercises, and will fast, and will meditate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do the Samanas practice? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Fasting and self-denial

2. What can Siddhartha do in meditation? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Let his self pass into animals and things
3. What does he conclude about these practices? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: They are only temporary escapes from the self
4. Who is rumored to have attained enlightenment? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gotama, the Buddha
5. How does Siddhartha respond to the old Samana's anger? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He silences him with his gaze
6. Retell the three most important events of "With the Samanas" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: With the Samanas, Siddhartha learns fasting, enduring pain, and meditations that let his self pass into animals and objects. Yet after three years he concludes these are only escapes from the self, not true release. When rumors spread of Gotama, the Buddha, he and Govinda leave; Siddhartha masters the old Samana with his gaze before departing.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "With the Samanas"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "With the Samanas" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life." What does "numbing" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: numbing: a dulling of feeling or pain.
10. Reread: "And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana." What does "nirvana" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: nirvana: in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "With the Samanas" suggest about self-denial as a path? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest.
2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about self-denial as a path? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: "to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow" (With the Samanas, paragraph 3): The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. On characterization: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to

himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst…”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “With the Samanas”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: With the Samanas, Siddhartha learns fasting, enduring pain, and meditations that let his self pass into animals and objects. Yet after three years he concludes these are only escapes from the self, not true release. When rumors spread of Gotama, the Buddha, he and Govinda leave; Siddhartha masters…
6. How does “With the Samanas” build on “The Son of the Brahmin”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “A heron flew over the bamboo forest” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6): The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life. On structure: Three years pass in a few pages; the chapter turns when rumours of Gotama arrive. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With the Samanas, paragraph 11): His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's. On characterization: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow” (With the Samanas, paragraph 3): The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. On imagery: The heron, the dead jackal: Siddhartha "becomes" animals, vivid and strange. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “A heron flew over the bamboo forest” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6): The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With the Samanas, paragraph 11): His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow” (With the Samanas, paragraph 3): The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. On characterization: With the Samanas, Siddhartha practises fasting and meditation so hard that he can leave his body and enter animals' lives, but always returns to himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “With the Samanas” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about self-denial as a path? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “A heron flew over the bamboo forest” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6): The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “With the Samanas”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With

the Samanas, paragraph 11): His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow” (With the Samanas, paragraph 3): The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “A heron flew over the bamboo forest” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6): The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “With the Samanas” treats self-denial as a path with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With the Samanas, paragraph 11): His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Gotama” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “to become empty, empty of thirst, empty of wishing, empty of dreams, empty of joy and sorrow” (With the Samanas, paragraph 3): The goal of asceticism, stated in a list built on repetition. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about self-denial as a path? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2]

Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “A heron flew over the bamboo forest” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6): The start of the passage where he enters the animal's life. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Useful evidence: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With the Samanas, paragraph 11): His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's. Theme link: Siddhartha decides that the Samanas' path is only a way of escaping the self for a while, like a drunkard's escape. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Fasting and self-denial
   C. Warfare
   D. Trading goods
2. What can Siddhartha do in meditation?
   A. See the future
   B. Fly
   C. Let his self pass into animals and things
   D. Speak to the dead
3. What does he conclude about these practices?
   A. They bring wealth
   B. They should be taught to all
   C. They are only temporary escapes from the self
   D. They are perfect

4. Who is rumored to have attained enlightenment?
   A. Gotama, the Buddha
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamala
   D. His father
5. How does Siddhartha respond to the old Samana's anger?
   A. He silences him with his gaze
   B. He fights him
   C. He promises to return
   D. He apologizes
6. In the line “It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.”, what does “numbing” most nearly mean?
   A. infected and full of pus
   B. a dulling of feeling or pain
   C. in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering
   D. crouch or curl up
7. In the line “And Siddhartha: “He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.”, what does “nirvana” most nearly mean?
   A. crouch or curl up
   B. infected and full of pus
   C. in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering
   D. a dulling of feeling or pain

Answer key: 1. B (Fasting and self-denial); 2. C (Let his self pass into animals and things); 3. C (They are only temporary escapes from the self); 4. A (Gotama, the Buddha); 5. A (He silences him with his gaze); 6. B (a dulling of feeling or pain); 7. C (in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “With the Samanas,” how does Hesse show self-denial as a path? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In With the Samanas, how does Hesse develop the idea of self-denial as a path? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of With the Samanas (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of self-denial as a path. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what With the Samanas suggests about self-denial as a path. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in With the Samanas to complicate the reader's understanding of self-denial as a path. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate With the Samanas within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of self-denial as a path responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read With the Samanas alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of self-denial as a path follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to With the Samanas and its treatment of self-denial as a path. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads With the Samanas as evidence for a larger claim about self-denial as a path in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads With the Samanas as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of self-denial as a path. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "festering" most nearly mean?

   A. infected and full of pus
   B. reflect deeply on a subject
   C. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice
   D. sink below the surface; go under or as if under water

2. *Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more. Silently, he stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and the penitent stood there, until he could not feel the cold in his shoulders and legs any more, until they were silent, until they were quiet. Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "With the Samanas"?

   A. Restlessness despite privilege
   B. Self-denial as a path
   C. Entering the city and learning love
   D. Wisdom cannot be taught

SAT key: 1. A (infected and full of pus); 2. B (Self-denial as a path)

Lesson 4: Gotama

Focus: the teacher and the teaching

Teacher only · spoilers

In the grove of Jetavana, Siddhartha and Govinda hear Gotama teach. Govinda joins the Buddha's followers. Siddhartha deeply admires Gotama but explains to him that enlightenment cannot be taught in words; each person must find it alone. Gotama warns him gently against too much cleverness, and Siddhartha leaves, feeling Gotama has taken his friend but given him himself.

Background: Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name.

Significance: The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to teaching versus experience because....*
> **Prompt:** Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to teaching versus experience because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: novices — beginners in a religious order; discard — to reject; to throw away; enticed — tempted; attracted; venerated — regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of; exhaled — expel air. “discard”: dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." “venerated”: From Latin venerari "to revere, worship," related to venus "love, desire." (Not from venire "to come.")*
> **Words:** novices: beginners in a religious order · discard: to reject; to throw away · enticed: tempted; attracted · venerated: regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of · exhaled: expel air

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name. The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted. Characterization: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once. Dialogue: Siddhartha's conversation with Gotama: he praises the teaching, then explains why he cannot follow it. Conflict: Govinda joins the Buddha; the friends separate. Watch for teachers and teachings: Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "to see him, the perfected one, and to hear the teachings from his mouth" (Gotama, paragraph 3).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36). The Buddha's gracious response. That is characterization at work: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once.

> *You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply (Gotama, paragraph 36)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36). The Buddha's gracious response. That is characterization at work: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Siddhartha's love for Gotama makes his rejection more surprising and serious. The Buddha's warning shows he sees Siddhartha's danger: pride in his own cleverness. Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience? Expected: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. (The depth of his respect before his refusal.)

> *Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one (Gotama, paragraph 15)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Siddhartha's love for Gotama makes his rejection more surprising and serious. The Buddha's warning shows he sees Siddhartha's danger: pride in his own cleverness.
Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience?
Expected answer: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. (The depth of his respect before his refusal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the teacher and the teaching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. When the text says "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. Although he says he had never "venerated a person so much," he argues the Buddha reached enlightenment by his own search, so following any teaching, even this one, would betray that example.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the teacher and the teaching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. When the text says "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. Although he says he had never "venerated a person so much," he argues the Buddha reached enlightenment by his own search, so following any teaching, even this one, would betray that example.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires? Ask: is Siddhartha right that enlightenment can't be taught? What about this class?

Anchor question: Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?

Facilitation: Ask: is Siddhartha right that enlightenment can't be taught? What about this class?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the teacher and the teaching? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. ("Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one", Gotama, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the teacher and the teaching? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. ("Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one", Gotama, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the teacher and the teaching. Key takeaway: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once.
- **Dialogue:** Siddhartha's conversation with Gotama: he praises the teaching, then explains why he cannot follow it.
- **Conflict:** Govinda joins the Buddha; the friends separate.

Themes and how they develop

- **teaching versus experience:** Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it.

Symbols and motifs

- **teachers and teachings:** Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "to see him, the perfected one, and to hear the teachings from his mouth" (Gotama, paragraph 3).
- **the smile:** The serene smile of Gotama, later of Vasudeva and finally of Siddhartha, marks enlightenment. In this chapter: "calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling" (Gotama, paragraph 12).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15) The depth of his respect before his refusal.
- "You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36) The Buddha's gracious response.
- "Be aware of too much wisdom" (Gotama, paragraph 42) Gotama's warning.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example.
Evidence: "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15)
Reasoning: Although he says he had never "venerated a person so much," he argues the Buddha reached enlightenment by his own search, so following any teaching, even this one, would betray that example.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
novices (noun)	beginners in a religious order	*Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
discard (verb)	to reject; to throw away	*There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.*	"discard": dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/discard)
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
venerated (verb)	regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of	*Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one.*	"venerated": From Latin venerari "to revere, worship," related to venus "love, desire." (Not from venire "to come.") (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/venerate)
exhaled (verb)	expel air	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

glistened (verb)	be shiny, as if wet	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	"glistened": From Old English glisnian "to gleam," a Germanic word related to glitter and gleam. (Not from Latin tenere.) (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/glisten)
openness (noun)	frankness; honesty	*With half of a smile, with an unwavering openness and kindness, Gotama looked into the stranger's eyes and bid him to leave with a hardly noticeable gesture.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
equanimity (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*The Buddha's eyes quietly looked to the ground; quietly, in perfect equanimity his inscrutable face was smiling.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dangling (verb)	hang freely	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
renounced (verb)	give up, such as power, as of monarchs and emperors, or duties and obligations	*You have renounced your home and your parents, renounced your birth and possessions, renounced your free will, renounced all friendship.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where do they hear Gotama teach? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In the grove of Jetavana
2. What does Govinda decide? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To join Gotama's followers
3. What does Siddhartha tell Gotama? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Enlightenment cannot be taught in words
4. What does Gotama warn Siddhartha about? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Being too clever
5. What does Siddhartha feel Gotama gave him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Himself
6. Retell the three most important events of "Gotama" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In the grove of Jetavana, Siddhartha and Govinda hear Gotama teach. Govinda joins the Buddha's followers. Siddhartha deeply admires Gotama but explains to him that enlightenment cannot be taught in words; each person must find it alone. Gotama warns him gently against too much cleverness, and Siddhartha leaves, feeling Gotama has taken his friend but given him himself.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Gotama"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Gotama" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices." What does "novices" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: novices: beginners in a religious order.
10. Reread: "There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them." What does "discard" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: discard: to reject; to throw away.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Gotama" suggest about the teacher and the teaching? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the teacher and the teaching? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15): The depth of his respect before his refusal. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience,

not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Gotama”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In the grove of Jetavana, Siddhartha and Govinda hear Gotama teach. Govinda joins the Buddha's followers. Siddhartha deeply admires Gotama but explains to him that enlightenment cannot be taught in words; each person must find it alone. Gotama warns him gently against too much cleverness, and…
6. How does “Gotama” build on “With the Samanas”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “You’ve heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you’ve thought about it thus deeply” (Gotama, paragraph 36): The Buddha's gracious response. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Be aware of too much wisdom” (Gotama, paragraph 42): Gotama's warning. On characterization: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the unity of all things? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one” (Gotama, paragraph 15): The depth of his respect before his refusal. On conflict: Govinda joins the Buddha; the friends separate. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “You’ve heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for

you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36): The Buddha's gracious response. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: "Be aware of too much wisdom" (Gotama, paragraph 42): Gotama's warning. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15): The depth of his respect before his refusal. On characterization: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Gotama" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the teacher and the teaching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: "You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36): The Buddha's gracious response. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Gotama": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: "Be aware of too much wisdom" (Gotama, paragraph 42): Gotama's warning. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the river and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one” (Gotama, paragraph 15): The depth of his respect before his refusal. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “You’ve heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you’ve thought about it thus deeply” (Gotama, paragraph 36): The Buddha's gracious response. On characterization: Gotama, the Buddha, is shown through his calm walk and smile; Siddhartha reveres him at once. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Gotama” treats the teacher and the teaching with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Be aware of too much wisdom” (Gotama, paragraph 42): Gotama's warning. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Awakening” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one” (Gotama, paragraph 15): The depth of his respect before his refusal. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the teacher and the teaching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “You’ve heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you’ve thought about it thus deeply” (Gotama, paragraph 36): The Buddha's gracious response. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-

generated question answered from evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha leaves the Buddha out of respect for the Buddha's own example. Useful evidence: “Be aware of too much wisdom” (Gotama, paragraph 42): Gotama's warning. Theme link: Siddhartha argues the Buddha found enlightenment through his own experience, not through any teaching, so teaching cannot transmit it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a city market
   B. In a palace
   C. By the river
   D. In the grove of Jetavana
2. What does Govinda decide?
   A. To become a merchant
   B. To return home
   C. To follow Siddhartha
   D. To join Gotama's followers
3. What does Siddhartha tell Gotama?
   A. He will return later
   B. He wants to be a monk
   C. Enlightenment cannot be taught in words
   D. His teachings are false
4. What does Gotama warn Siddhartha about?
   A. Loving too much
   B. Being too poor
   C. Being too clever
   D. Being lazy
5. What does Siddhartha feel Gotama gave him?
   A. A robe
   B. A mantra
   C. Himself
   D. A begging bowl

6. In the line “Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.”, what does “novices” most nearly mean?
   A. beginners in a religious order
   B. regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of
   C. to reject; to throw away
   D. tempted; attracted
7. In the line “There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.”, what does “discard” most nearly mean?
   A. beginners in a religious order
   B. to reject; to throw away
   C. tempted; attracted
   D. regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of

Answer key: 1. D (In the grove of Jetavana); 2. D (To join Gotama's followers); 3. C (Enlightenment cannot be taught in words); 4. C (Being too clever); 5. C (Himself); 6. A (beginners in a religious order); 7. B (to reject; to throw away)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Gotama,” how does Hesse show the teacher and the teaching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Gotama, how does Hesse develop the idea of the teacher and the teaching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Gotama (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the teacher and the teaching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Gotama suggests about the teacher and the teaching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Gotama to complicate the reader's understanding of the teacher and the teaching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Gotama within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the teacher and the teaching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Gotama alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the teacher and the teaching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Gotama and its treatment of the teacher and the teaching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Gotama as evidence for a larger claim about the teacher and the teaching in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Gotama as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the teacher and the teaching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "enticed" most nearly mean?

   A. tempted; attracted

   B. hang freely

   C. give up, such as power, as of monarchs and emperors, or duties and obligations

   D. steadiness of mind under stress

2. *The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling a healthy child, the Buddha walked, wore the robe and placed his feet just as all of his monks did, according to a precise rule. But his face and his walk, his quietly lowered glance, his quietly dangling hand and even every finger of his quietly dangling hand expressed peace, expressed perfection, did not search, did not imitate, breathed softly in an unwithering calm, in an unwithering light, an untouchable peace.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Gotama"?

A. Hearing the many voices

B. The teacher and the teaching

C. Wisdom cannot be taught

D. Learning from the river

SAT key: 1. A (tempted; attracted); 2. B (The teacher and the teaching)

Lesson 5: Awakening

Focus: awakening to the world

Teacher only · spoilers

Walking away, Siddhartha realizes he has always fled from himself and resolves to learn from himself. Suddenly the world appears new and beautiful—colors, rivers, forests—no longer illusion but reality to be experienced. He feels a chill of loneliness: he is no longer a Brahmin or a Samana, but he will not go home.

Background: In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya.

Significance: This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the search for the self because....*
> **Prompt:** What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the search for the self because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself."

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: dissect — to cut apart in order to examine closely; inhaled — breathed in; deceptions — tricks; false appearances; heading — going toward; teachings — ideas or principles taught by someone.*
> **Words:** dissect: to cut apart in order to examine closely · inhaled: breathed in · deceptions: tricks; false appearances · heading: going toward · teachings: ideas or principles taught by someone

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya. This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life. Structure: The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns physically ("he stopped … as if there was a snake lying in front of him"). Imagery: After the awakening the world floods in as colour ("Here was blue, here was yellow, here was green"), no longer "the veil of Maya." The sensory lists are the meaning: the visible world is now worth reading. FigurativeLanguage: Two key images: the self shed "as a snake is left by its old skin," and the "book of the world," whose letters he had scorned. Then the cold of being "alone like a star in the sky." Watch for the snake: twice the snake appears, first as shed skin (renewal), then as an obstacle on the path (the sudden shock of loneliness).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself" (Awakening, paragraph 4). The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. That is structure at work: The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns physically ("he stopped … as if there was a snake lying in front of him").

> *I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself (Awakening, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself" (Awakening, paragraph 4). The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. That is structure at work: The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns physically ("he stopped … as if there was a snake lying in front of him").

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The inverted order ("Beautiful was the world") and the threefold repetition make the sentence sound like a prayer, so the ordinary world becomes holy. Expected link: the search for the self now runs through the world, not away from it. Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self? Expected: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." (Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred.)

> *Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world (Awakening, paragraph 7)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The inverted order ("Beautiful was the world") and the threefold repetition make the sentence sound like a prayer, so the ordinary world becomes holy. Expected link: the search for the self now runs through the world, not away from it.
Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self?
Expected answer: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." (Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about awakening to the world? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. When the text says “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. He realizes "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and now sees that "beautiful was the world, colourful was the world"; but in the same moment he stands "alone like a star in the sky," because he no longer belongs to any group.

Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about awakening to the world? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. When the text says “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. He realizes "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and now sees that "beautiful was the world, colourful was the world"; but in the same moment he stands "alone like a star in the sky," because he no longer belongs to any group.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter? Ask students to find the two snake images and explain what each one marks. Push: is being "alone like a star" a victory or a loss? Accept both if argued from the cold/shiver passage.

Anchor question: What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?

Facilitation: Ask students to find the two snake images and explain what each one marks. · Push: is being "alone like a star" a victory or a loss? Accept both if argued from the cold/shiver passage.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about awakening to the world? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. ("I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself", Awakening, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about awakening to the world? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. ("I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself", Awakening, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes awakening to the world. Key takeaway: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns physically ("he stopped ... as if there was a snake lying in front of him").
- **Imagery:** After the awakening the world floods in as colour ("Here was blue, here was yellow, here was green"), no longer "the veil of Maya." The sensory lists are the meaning: the visible world is now worth reading.
- **FigurativeLanguage:** Two key images: the self shed "as a snake is left by its old skin," and the "book of the world," whose letters he had scorned. Then the cold of being "alone like a star in the sky."

Themes and how they develop

- **the search for the self:** Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself."

Symbols and motifs

- **the snake:** twice the snake appears, first as shed skin (renewal), then as an obstacle on the path (the sudden shock of loneliness).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself" (Awakening, paragraph 4) The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self.
- "Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world" (Awakening, paragraph 7) Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred.
- "when he stood alone like a star in the sky" (Awakening, paragraph 12) The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone.
Evidence: "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself" (Awakening, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: He realizes "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and now sees that "beautiful was the world, colourful was the world"; but in the same moment he stands "alone like a star in the sky," because he no longer belongs to any group.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dissect (verb)	to cut apart in order to examine closely	*I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inhaled (verb)	breathed in	*Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
deceptions (noun)	tricks; false appearances	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
heading (verb)	going toward	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
teachings (noun)	ideas or principles taught by someone	*He had also left the last teacher who had appeared on his path, even him, the highest and wisest teacher, the most holy one, Buddha, he had left him, had to part with him, was not able to accept his teachings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
strides (noun)	a step in walking or running		

		And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.	Student look-up (not yet verified)
workers (noun)	a person who works at a specific occupation	*There was no nobleman who did not belong to the noblemen, no worker that did not belong to the workers, and found refuge with them, shared their life, spoke their language.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
perfected (verb)	make perfect or complete	*When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
symbols (noun)	an arbitrary sign (written or printed) that has acquired a conventional significance	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
coincidence (noun)	an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Himself
2. How does the world appear to him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: New and beautiful
3. What does he feel after the awakening? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A cold loneliness

4. Does Siddhartha go home to his father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: No, he moves forward alone
5. What idea does he reject here? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Seeing the world as mere illusion
6. Retell the three most important events of "Awakening" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walking away, Siddhartha realizes he has always fled from himself and resolves to learn from himself. Suddenly the world appears new and beautiful—colors, rivers, forests—no longer illusion but reality to be experienced. He feels a chill of loneliness: he is no longer a Brahmin or a Samana, but he will not go home.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Awakening"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Awakening" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part." What does "dissect" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: dissect: to cut apart in order to examine closely.
10. Reread: "Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered." What does "inhaled" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: inhaled: breathed in.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Awakening" suggest about awakening to the world? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.
2. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about awakening to the world? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself" (Awakening, paragraph 4): The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind…", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Awakening”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walking away, Siddhartha realizes he has always fled from himself and resolves to learn from himself. Suddenly the world appears new and beautiful—colors, rivers, forests—no longer illusion but reality to be experienced. He feels a chill of loneliness: he is no longer a Brahmin or a Samana, but he…
6. How does “Awakening” build on “Gotama”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world” (Awakening, paragraph 7): Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred. On structure: The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns physically ("he stopped ... as if there was a snake lying in front of him"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “when he stood alone like a star in the sky” (Awakening, paragraph 12): The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the river and time? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4): The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world” (Awakening,

paragraph 7): Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “when he stood alone like a star in the sky” (Awakening, paragraph 12): The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4): The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Awakening” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about awakening to the world? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world” (Awakening, paragraph 7): Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Awakening”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “when he stood alone like a star in the sky” (Awakening, paragraph 12): The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew

himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to love and attachment: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4): The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world” (Awakening, paragraph 7): Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred. On imagery: After the awakening the world floods in as colour ("Here was blue, here was yellow, here was green"), no longer "the veil of Maya." The sensory lists are the meaning: the visible world is now worth reading. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Awakening” treats awakening to the world with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “when he stood alone like a star in the sky” (Awakening, paragraph 12): The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Kamala” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself” (Awakening, paragraph 4): The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself."

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about awakening to the world? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “Beautiful was the world, colourful was the world, strange and mysterious was the world” (Awakening, paragraph 7): Inverted word order and repetition give the line the rhythm of a hymn: the world itself is now sacred. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone. Useful evidence: “when he stood alone like a star in the sky” (Awakening, paragraph 12): The cost of freedom: no caste, no teacher, no home. The simile is both beautiful and cold. Theme link: Siddhartha realizes he never knew himself because "I was afraid of myself, I was fleeing from myself," and resolves to "learn from myself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. His father
   B. The Samanas
   C. Himself
   D. The Buddha
2. How does the world appear to him?
   A. New and beautiful
   B. Frightening
   C. Unreal
   D. Grey and dull

3. What does he feel after the awakening?
   A. A cold loneliness
   B. Anger
   C. Pride in his caste
   D. Hunger
4. Does Siddhartha go home to his father?
   A. He sends a letter
   B. No, he moves forward alone
   C. Yes, to say goodbye
   D. Yes, at once
5. What idea does he reject here?
   A. Seeing the world as mere illusion
   B. Self-knowledge
   C. Learning from nature
   D. Being alone
6. In the line "I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.", what does "dissect" most nearly mean?
   A. breathed in
   B. tricks; false appearances
   C. going toward
   D. to cut apart in order to examine closely
7. In the line "Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.", what does "inhaled" most nearly mean?
   A. tricks; false appearances
   B. to cut apart in order to examine closely
   C. going toward
   D. breathed in

Answer key: 1. C (Himself); 2. A (New and beautiful); 3. A (A cold loneliness); 4. B (No, he moves forward alone); 5. A (Seeing the world as mere illusion); 6. D (to cut apart in order to examine closely); 7. D (breathed in)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Awakening," how does Hesse show awakening to the world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Awakening, how does Hesse develop the idea of awakening to the world? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how

the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Awakening (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of awakening to the world. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Awakening suggests about awakening to the world. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses imagery in Awakening to complicate the reader's understanding of awakening to the world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Awakening within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of awakening to the world responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Awakening alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of awakening to the world follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Awakening and its treatment of awakening to the world. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Awakening as evidence for a larger claim about awakening to the world in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Awakening as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of awakening to the world. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "deceptions" most nearly mean?

   A. an arbitrary sign (written or printed) that has acquired a conventional significance

   B. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

   C. tricks; false appearances

   D. make perfect or complete

2. *When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him. He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along. He pondered deeply, like diving into a deep water he let himself sink down to the ground of the sensation, down to the place where the causes lie, because to identify the causes, so it seemed to him, is the very essence of thinking, and by this alone sensations turn into realizations and are not lost, but become entities and start to emit like rays of light what is inside of them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Awakening"?

   A. Detachment among the childlike people

   B. The pain of a father's love

   C. Awakening to the world

   D. Self-denial as a path

SAT key: 1. C (tricks; false appearances); 2. C (Awakening to the world)

Lesson 6: Kamala

Focus: entering the city and learning love

Content note (sexual content): Kamala is a courtesan and teaches Siddhartha “the art of love”. Keep discussion on desire and attachment as ideas; no detail is needed.
Student preview: This chapter refers to a romantic and sexual relationship.
Suggested language: “What does Siddhartha want from Kamala, and what does he learn?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha dreams of Govinda becoming a woman, crosses a river with a kind ferryman (Vasudeva) who predicts his return, and reaches a city where he sees the beautiful courtesan Kamala. She tells him he needs fine clothes, shoes and money; he learns quickly and, through her, gains a position with the merchant Kamaswami. Kamala becomes his teacher in love.

Background: Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected.

Significance: The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to teaching versus experience because.... Content note before we start: This chapter refers to a romantic and sexual relationship.
Prompt: Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to teaching versus experience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disembarking — getting off a boat; seashells — the shells of sea creatures; shimmered — shone with a soft, wavering light; pouches — a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things; cistern — a tank for storing water.
Words: disembarking: getting off a boat · seashells: the shells of sea creatures · shimmered: shone with a soft, wavering light · pouches: a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things · cistern: a tank for storing water

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected. The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting. Characterization: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love. Foreshadowing: The ferryman's parting words ("everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back") predict the whole second half of the novel. Dialogue: With Kamala, Siddhartha bargains like a merchant: he has nothing to offer but his three skills, "I can think. I can wait. I can fast." Watch for the river and the ferry: the river he crosses here separates the life of the spirit from the life of the city; he will cross it back.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I can think. I can wait. I can fast" (Kamala, paragraph 42). Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love.

> *I can think. I can wait. I can fast* (Kamala, paragraph 42)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I can think. I can wait. I can fast" (Kamala, paragraph 42). Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Everything is coming back" introduces the cycle (Sansara) and the river as teacher. Expected answer: the line foreshadows his return and connects the river to time and repetition. Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience? Expected: After rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. (Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher.)

> *This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back* (Kamala, paragraph 11)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Everything is coming back" introduces the cycle (Sansara) and the river as teacher. Expected answer: the line foreshadows his return and connects the river to time and repetition.
Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience?
Expected answer: After rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. (Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about entering the city and learning love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. When the text says “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. The ferryman says "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back," naming the river as his teacher and predicting Siddhartha's return long before it happens.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about entering the city and learning love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. When the text says “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. The ferryman says "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back," naming the river as his teacher and predicting Siddhartha's return long before it happens.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills? Ask: why does Siddhartha want Kamala as a teacher when he refused the Buddha? Is that consistent?

Anchor question: Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?

Facilitation: Ask: why does Siddhartha want Kamala as a teacher when he refused the Buddha? Is that consistent?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about entering the city and learning love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. (“This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back”, Kamala, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about entering the city and learning love? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. (“This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back”, Kamala, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes entering the city and learning love. Key takeaway: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love.
- **Foreshadowing:** The ferryman's parting words ("everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back") predict the whole second half of the novel.
- **Dialogue:** With Kamala, Siddhartha bargains like a merchant: he has nothing to offer but his three skills, "I can think. I can wait. I can fast."

Themes and how they develop

- **teaching versus experience:** after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience.

Symbols and motifs

- **the river and the ferry:** the river he crosses here separates the life of the spirit from the life of the city; he will cross it back.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back" (Kamala, paragraph 11) Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher.
- "I can think. I can wait. I can fast" (Kamala, paragraph 42) Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city.
- "Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods" (Kamala, paragraph 11) Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back.
Evidence: "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back" (Kamala, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: The ferryman says "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back," naming the river as his teacher and predicting Siddhartha's return long before it happens.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disembarking (verb)	getting off a boat	*"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seashells (noun)	the shells of sea creatures	*In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shimmered (verb)	shone with a soft, wavering light	*It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.—When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pouches (noun)	a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things	*Many young men come to me, and there are also sons of Brahmins among them, but they come in beautiful clothes, they come in fine shoes, they have perfume in their hair and money in their pouches.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cistern (noun)	a tank for storing water	*Differently the sun burnt the head, differently the shade of the forest cooled him down, differently the stream and the cistern, the pumpkin and the banana tasted.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rainbows (noun)	an arc of colored light in the sky caused by refraction of the sun's rays by rain	*He saw trees, stars, animals, clouds, rainbows, rocks, herbs, flowers, stream and river, the glistening dew in the bushes in the morning, distant high mountains which were blue and pale, birds sang and bees, wind silverishly blew through the rice field.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

clanged (verb)	make a loud noise	*Kamala loudly clapped her hands, so that the golden bracelets clanged.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
jackals (noun)	wild dogs that hunt or scavenge	*"Why should I be afraid of a Samana, a stupid Samana from the forest, who is coming from the jackals and doesn't even know yet what women are?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
peacocks (noun)	male peafowl, birds with large, colorful tail feathers	*Kamala smiled, played with her fan of peacocks' feathers, and asked: "And only to tell me this, Siddhartha has come to me?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
courtesan (noun)	a woman paid to be the companion of wealthy men	*When, late in the afternoon, beautiful Kamala approached her grove in her sedan-chair, Siddhartha was standing at the entrance, made a bow and received the courtesan's greeting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Vasudeva
2. What does the ferryman predict? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha will return
3. Who is Kamala? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A beautiful courtesan
4. What three skills does Siddhartha name? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Thinking, waiting and fasting
5. Who gives Siddhartha work? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The merchant Kamaswami
6. Retell the three most important events of "Kamala" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha dreams of Govinda becoming a woman, crosses a river with a kind ferryman (Vasudeva) who predicts his return, and reaches a city where he sees the beautiful courtesan Kamala. She tells

him he needs fine clothes, shoes and money; he learns quickly and, through her, gains a position with the merchant Kamaswami. Kamala becomes his teacher in love.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Kamala”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Kamala” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ““I thank you, my benefactor,” spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.” What does “disembarking” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: disembarking: getting off a boat.
10. Reread: “In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.” What does “seashells” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: seashells: the shells of sea creatures.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Kamala” suggest about entering the city and learning love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about entering the city and learning love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““I thank you, my benefactor,””, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Kamala”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha dreams of Govinda becoming a woman, crosses a river with a kind ferryman (Vasudeva) who predicts his return, and reaches a city where he sees the beautiful courtesan Kamala. She tells him he needs fine clothes, shoes and money; he learns quickly and, through her, gains a position with…
6. How does “Kamala” build on “Awakening”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “I can think. I can wait. I can fast” (Kamala, paragraph 42): Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as

currency in the city. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship. On characterization: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with love and attachment? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “I can think. I can wait. I can fast” (Kamala, paragraph 42): Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still

learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher. On characterization: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Kamala” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about entering the city and learning love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “I can think. I can wait. I can fast” (Kamala, paragraph 42): Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Kamala”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the search for self-knowledge: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that

Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “I can think. I can wait. I can fast” (Kamala, paragraph 42): Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. On characterization: Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman Vasudeva carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Kamala” treats entering the city and learning love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “With the Childlike People” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva's prophecy; the river is already a teacher. On foreshadowing: The ferryman's parting words ("everything is coming back! You too, Samana, will come back") predict the whole second half of the novel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about entering the city and learning love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “I can think. I can wait. I can fast” (Kamala, paragraph 42): Siddhartha's three skills: everything his ascetic life gave him, offered as currency in the city. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Vasudeva's words at the river foreshadow that Siddhartha's journey into the world is a detour that will lead back. Useful evidence: “Commemorate me when you make offerings to the gods” (Kamala, paragraph 11): Vasudeva asks no payment but friendship. Theme link: after rejecting every spiritual teacher, Siddhartha chooses a teacher of the senses; he still learns, but now through experience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Govinda
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Gotama
2. What does the ferryman predict?
   A. He will be rich
   B. Siddhartha will return
   C. He will die young
   D. He will become a monk
3. Who is Kamala?
   A. Siddhartha's sister
   B. A merchant's wife
   C. A beautiful courtesan
   D. A Samana
4. What three skills does Siddhartha name?
   A. Fighting, riding and hunting
   B. Reading, writing and singing
   C. Trading, cooking and building
   D. Thinking, waiting and fasting
5. Who gives Siddhartha work?
   A. The merchant Kamaswami
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Govinda
   D. His father
6. In the line ""I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.", what does "disembarking" most nearly mean?
   A. the shells of sea creatures
   B. a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things
   C. shone with a soft, wavering light
   D. getting off a boat

7. In the line “In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.”, what does “seashells” most nearly mean?
   A. getting off a boat
   B. a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things
   C. shone with a soft, wavering light
   D. the shells of sea creatures

Answer key: 1. B (Vasudeva); 2. B (Siddhartha will return); 3. C (A beautiful courtesan); 4. D (Thinking, waiting and fasting); 5. A (The merchant Kamaswami); 6. D (getting off a boat); 7. D (the shells of sea creatures)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Kamala,” how does Hesse show entering the city and learning love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Kamala, how does Hesse develop the idea of entering the city and learning love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Kamala (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of entering the city and learning love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Kamala suggests about entering the city and learning love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Kamala to complicate the reader's understanding of entering the city and learning love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Kamala within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of entering the city and learning love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Kamala alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of entering the city and learning love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Kamala and its treatment of entering the city and learning love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Kamala as evidence for a larger claim about entering the city and learning love in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Kamala as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of entering the city and learning love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.— When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “shimmered” most nearly mean?

   A. shone with a soft, wavering light

   B. male peafowl, birds with large, colorful tail feathers

   C. a woman paid to be the companion of wealthy men

   D. wild dogs that hunt or scavenge

2. *“I thank you, my benefactor,” spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river. “I have no gift I could give you for your hospitality, my dear, and also no payment for your work. I am a man without a home, a son of a Brahmin and a Samana.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Kamala”?

   A. Entering the city and learning love

   B. The pain of a father's love

   C. The teacher and the teaching

   D. Detachment among the childlike people

SAT key: 1. A (shone with a soft, wavering light); 2. A (Entering the city and learning love)

Lesson 7: With the Childlike People

Focus: detachment among the childlike people

Content note (sexual content, condescending language): Continues the relationship with Kamala; the narrator calls ordinary people “childlike people”. Question that condescension.
Student preview: The chapter continues the relationship and calls ordinary people 'childlike'.
Suggested language: “Is Siddhartha right to look down on the 'childlike people'?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha works for Kamaswami but treats business as a game, caring little for profit, which irritates the merchant yet makes Siddhartha successful. He watches ordinary people—the 'childlike people'—with amusement as they suffer over money and desire. Kamala teaches him the art of love, and they agree that neither of them can truly love.

Background: Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire.

Significance: Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and attachment because.... Content note before we start: The chapter continues the relationship and calls ordinary people 'childlike'.
Prompt: Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and attachment because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: businesses — jobs and daily affairs; storage — places where goods are kept; hastiness — acting too quickly; besiege — surround so as to force to give up; tumbles — falls.
Words: businesses: jobs and daily affairs · storage: places where goods are kept · hastiness: acting too quickly · besiege: surround so as to force to give up · tumbles: falls

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire. Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on. Characterization: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala. FigurativeLanguage: His image of people: most are "like a falling leaf," a few "like stars" with their own course. It reveals his pride. Irony: Siddhartha calls ordinary people "childlike" and feels superior, while slowly becoming one of them. Watch for teachers and teachings: Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "told," the merchant began, "that you were a Brahmin, a learned man, but that you seek to be in the service of" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 3).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26). What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala.

> *Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26). What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Leaves are blown by the wind; stars follow their own law. Siddhartha thinks he is a star. Kamala's line suggests that his superiority keeps him from love, which links to love and attachment. Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment? Expected: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. (The simile that shows how he sees others.)

> *Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Leaves are blown by the wind; stars follow their own law. Siddhartha thinks he is a star. Kamala's line suggests that his superiority keeps him from love, which links to love and attachment.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment?
Expected answer: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. (The simile that shows how he sees others.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, figurativelanguage (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about detachment among the childlike people? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. When the text says “Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42), it shows this directly. He compares most people to "a falling leaf" and himself, implicitly, to the stars, and Kamala sees the cost: "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can."

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, figurativelanguage (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about detachment among the childlike people? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. When the text says “Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42), it shows this directly. He compares most people to "a falling leaf" and himself, implicitly, to the stars, and Kamala sees the cost: "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant? Ask: are the "childlike people" really inferior? What do they have that Siddhartha lacks?

Anchor question: Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?

Facilitation: Ask: are the "childlike people" really inferior? What do they have that Siddhartha lacks?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about detachment among the childlike people? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. ("Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground", With the Childlike People, paragraph 42). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about detachment among the childlike people? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. ("Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground", With the Childlike People, paragraph 42). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes detachment among the childlike people. Key takeaway: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala.
- **FigurativeLanguage:** His image of people: most are "like a falling leaf," a few "like stars" with their own course. It reveals his pride.
- **Irony:** Siddhartha calls ordinary people "childlike" and feels superior, while slowly becoming one of them.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and attachment:** Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit.

Symbols and motifs

- **teachers and teachings:** Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "told," the merchant began, "that you were a Brahmin, a learned man, but that you seek to be in the service of" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 3).
- **the smile:** The serene smile of Gotama, later of Vasudeva and finally of Siddhartha, marks enlightenment. In this chapter: "them complaining about pain at which a Samana would only smile, and

suffering because of deprivations which a Samana would not feel" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 37).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26) What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form.
- "Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42) The simile that shows how he sees others.
- "Perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can; that's their secret" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47) Kamala names their shared weakness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love.
Evidence: "Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42)
Reasoning: He compares most people to "a falling leaf" and himself, implicitly, to the stars, and Kamala sees the cost: "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
businesses (noun)	jobs and daily affairs	*Besides from this, Siddhartha's interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
storage (noun)	places where goods are kept	*Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hastiness (noun)	acting too quickly	*But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
besiege (verb)	surround so as to force to give up	*But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tumbles (verb)	falls	*Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
flexible (adjective)	able to bend easily	*Her body was flexible like that of a jaguar and like the bow of a hunter; he who had learned from her how to make love, was knowledgeable of many forms of lust, many secrets.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

admonished (verb)	warned or scolded gently	*At times he felt, deep in his chest, a dying, quiet voice, which admonished him quietly, lamented quietly; he hardly perceived it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shipping (verb)	transport commercially	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carpets (noun)	floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)	*Siddhartha went to Kamaswami the merchant, he was directed into a rich house, servants led him between precious carpets into a chamber, where he awaited the master of the house.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
calmness (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Siddhartha treat business? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: As a game he does not take seriously
2. What does he call ordinary people? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The childlike people
3. How does Kamaswami feel about Siddhartha's attitude? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Irritated but impressed by results
4. What do Siddhartha and Kamala agree about? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Neither can truly love
5. What is ironic about his view of others? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is slowly becoming like them

6. Retell the three most important events of “With the Childlike People” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha works for Kamaswami but treats business as a game, caring little for profit, which irritates the merchant yet makes Siddhartha successful. He watches ordinary people—the 'childlike people'—with amusement as they suffer over money and desire. Kamala teaches him the art of love, and they agree that neither of them can truly love.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “With the Childlike People”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “With the Childlike People” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Besides from this, Siddhartha’s interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.” What does “businesses” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: businesses: jobs and daily affairs.
10. Reread: “Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.” What does “storage” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: storage: places where goods are kept.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “With the Childlike People” suggest about detachment among the childlike people? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about detachment among the childlike people? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26): What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. On irony: Siddhartha calls ordinary people "childlike" and feels superior, while slowly becoming one of them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““It is very good, sir.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “With the Childlike People”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha works for Kamaswami but treats business as a game, caring little for profit, which irritates the merchant yet makes Siddhartha successful. He watches ordinary people—the 'childlike people'—with amusement as they suffer over money and desire. Kamala teaches him the art of love, and they…

6. How does “With the Childlike People” build on “Kamala”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42): The simile that shows how he sees others. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Perhaps people of our kind can’t love. The childlike people can; that’s their secret” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47): Kamala names their shared weakness. On characterization: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26): What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42): The simile that shows how he sees others. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Perhaps people of our kind can’t love. The childlike people can; that’s their secret” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47): Kamala names their shared weakness. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26): What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. On characterization: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “With the Childlike People” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about detachment among the childlike people? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42): The simile that shows how he sees others. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “With the Childlike People”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Perhaps people of our kind can’t love. The childlike people can; that’s their secret” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47): Kamala names their shared weakness. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good,

being patient is better" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26): What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: "Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42): The simile that shows how he sees others. On characterization: Siddhartha works for the merchant Kamaswami and learns trade, but treats it as a game; he learns love from Kamala. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "With the Childlike People" treats detachment among the childlike people with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: "Perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can; that's their secret" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47): Kamala names their shared weakness. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what "Sansara" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: "Writing is good, thinking is better. Being smart is good, being patient is better" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 26): What Siddhartha writes for Kamaswami: his ascetic values in proverb form. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about detachment among the childlike people? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: "Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 42): The simile that shows how he sees others. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's detachment in the city is a strength in business but a failure in love. Useful evidence: “Perhaps people of our kind can’t love. The childlike people can; that’s their secret” (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47): Kamala names their shared weakness. Theme link: Kamala says "perhaps people of our kind can't love. The childlike people can": both are detached, and that is their limit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
2. What does he call ordinary people?
   A. The childlike people
   B. The fallen ones
   C. The masters
   D. The sleepers
3. How does Kamaswami feel about Siddhartha's attitude?
   A. Irritated but impressed by results
   B. Indifferent
   C. Afraid
   D. Delighted
4. What do Siddhartha and Kamala agree about?
   A. They will marry
   B. Neither can truly love
   C. They will leave the city
   D. They should become Samanas
5. What is ironic about his view of others?
   A. He is slowly becoming like them
   B. He is their king

C. He is poorer than them

D. He does not see them

6. In the line “Besides from this, Siddhartha’s interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.”, what does “businesses” most nearly mean?

   A. places where goods are kept

   B. acting too quickly

   C. jobs and daily affairs

   D. surround so as to force to give up

7. In the line “Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.”, what does “storage” most nearly mean?

   A. acting too quickly

   B. jobs and daily affairs

   C. surround so as to force to give up

   D. places where goods are kept

Answer key: 1. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 2. A (The childlike people); 3. A (Irritated but impressed by results); 4. B (Neither can truly love); 5. A (He is slowly becoming like them); 6. C (jobs and daily affairs); 7. D (places where goods are kept)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “With the Childlike People,” how does Hesse show detachment among the childlike people? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In With the Childlike People, how does Hesse develop the idea of detachment among the childlike people? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of With the Childlike People (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of detachment among the childlike people. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what With the Childlike People suggests about detachment among the childlike people. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in With the Childlike People to complicate the reader's understanding of detachment among the childlike people. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate With the Childlike People within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of detachment among the childlike people responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read With the Childlike People alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of detachment among the childlike people follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to With the Childlike People and its treatment of detachment among the childlike people. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads With the Childlike People as evidence for a larger claim about detachment among the childlike people in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads With the Childlike People as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of detachment among the childlike people. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "hastiness" most nearly mean?

   A. floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)

   B. transport commercially

   C. steadiness of mind under stress

   D. acting too quickly

2. *"It is very good, sir. When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the smartest thing he could do. When, for example, Siddhartha hadn't learned to fast, he would have to accept any kind of service before that day is up, whether it may be with you or wherever, because hunger would force him to do so. But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it. This, sir, is what fasting is good for."*

Which choice best states a central concern of "With the Childlike People"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. Detachment among the childlike people

C. The teacher and the teaching

D. Despair and renewal by the river

SAT key: 1. D (acting too quickly); 2. B (Detachment among the childlike people)

Lesson 8: Sansara

Focus: the cycle of desire

Content note (gambling, drinking, self-disgust): Siddhartha sinks into gambling, drink and self-disgust. Be mindful of students affected by addiction in their families.
Student preview: Siddhartha gambles and drinks and grows to hate his life.
Suggested language: "What has Siddhartha lost, and how does he realize it?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Over many years Siddhartha grows wealthy, gambles, drinks, and becomes greedy and weary—like the childlike people. Kamala tells him she wishes to learn about Gotama. After a dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage, Siddhartha feels disgust at his life and leaves the city without a word. Kamala, pregnant with his child, frees her bird.

Background: Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth.

Significance: The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does the dead songbird symbolize? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and attachment because.... Content note before we start: Siddhartha gambles and drinks and grows to hate his life.
Prompt: What does the dead songbird symbolize?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and attachment because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: gambled — played games of chance for money; castaway — a person left stranded after a shipwreck; demonstrating — showing clearly; mockingly — in a disrespectful jeering manner; devious — indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading.
Words: gambled: played games of chance for money · castaway: a person left stranded after a shipwreck · demonstrating: showing clearly · mockingly: in a disrespectful jeering manner · devious: indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth. The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice. Structure: Years pass in summary; Siddhartha slowly takes on the habits he despised: gambling, wine, greed, fear. Imagery: The dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage: his inner voice has gone silent. Tone / mood: Weary and disgusted; the prose itself becomes heavy with lists of pleasures. Watch for the songbird in the golden cage: his own spirit, imprisoned by wealth, has died; when he leaves, Kamala sets the bird free.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on" (Sansara, paragraph 6). Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. That is structure at work: Years pass in summary; Siddhartha slowly takes on the habits he despised: gambling, wine, greed, fear.

> *He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on* (Sansara, paragraph 6)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on" (Sansara, paragraph 6). Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. That is structure at work: Years pass in summary; Siddhartha slowly takes on the habits he despised: gambling, wine, greed, fear.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The cage is golden (beautiful, costly) but still a cage: wealth imprisons. The mute bird is his inner voice. Expected link: Sansara as attractive captivity. Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment? Expected: The senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. (The dream that wakes him.)

> *Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt* (Sansara, paragraph 10)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The cage is golden (beautiful, costly) but still a cage: wealth imprisons. The mute bird is his inner voice. Expected link: Sansara as attractive captivity.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment?
Expected answer: The senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. (The dream that wakes him.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the cycle of desire? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. When the text says “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He dreams that the bird in its "golden cage" has become mute, and after he leaves, Kamala "opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly," marking his release.

Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the cycle of desire? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. When the text says “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He dreams that the bird in its "golden cage" has become mute, and after he leaves, Kamala "opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly," marking his release.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does the dead songbird symbolize? Ask: what modern "golden cages" can students name? Keep the discussion tied to the text.

Anchor question: What does the dead songbird symbolize?

Facilitation: Ask: what modern "golden cages" can students name? Keep the discussion tied to the text.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the cycle of desire? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. ("Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt", Sansara, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the cycle of desire? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. ("Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt", Sansara, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the cycle of desire. Key takeaway: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Years pass in summary; Siddhartha slowly takes on the habits he despised: gambling, wine, greed, fear.
- **Imagery:** The dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage: his inner voice has gone silent.
- **Tone / mood:** Weary and disgusted; the prose itself becomes heavy with lists of pleasures.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and attachment:** the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara.

Symbols and motifs

- **the songbird in the golden cage:** his own spirit, imprisoned by wealth, has died; when he leaves, Kamala sets the bird free.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt" (Sansara, paragraph 10) The dream that wakes him.
- "He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on" (Sansara, paragraph 6) Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world.

- "She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly" (Sansara, paragraph 17) Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth.
Evidence: "Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt" (Sansara, paragraph 10)
Reasoning: He dreams that the bird in its "golden cage" has become mute, and after he leaves, Kamala "opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly," marking his release.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
gambled (verb)	played games of chance for money	*Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
castaway (noun)	a person left stranded after a shipwreck	*Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
demonstrating (verb)	showing clearly	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mockingly (adverb)	in a disrespectful jeering manner	*He played the game due to a pain of his heart, losing and wasting his wretched money in the game brought him an angry joy, in no other way he could demonstrate his disdain for wealth, the merchants' false god, more clearly and more mockingly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devious (adjective)	indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading	*On a strange and devious way, Siddhartha had gotten into this final and most base of all dependencies, by means of the game of dice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
zealously (adverb)	in a zealous manner	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debtors (noun)	a person who owes a creditor; someone who has the obligation of paying a debt	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

reliable (adjective)	worthy of reliance or trust	*He only noticed that this bright and reliable voice inside of him, which had awoken in him at that time and had ever guided him in his best times, had become silent.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
encompassed (verb)	surrounded	*Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
poultry (noun)	chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food	*He had learned to eat tenderly and carefully prepared food, even fish, even meat and poultry, spices and sweets, and to drink wine, which causes sloth and forgetfulness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the dead songbird symbolize?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He becomes greedy and weary
2. What does Siddhartha dream about? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Kamala's songbird dead in its cage
3. How does Siddhartha leave the city? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Suddenly, without a word
4. What does Kamala do after he leaves? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Frees her songbird
5. What is Sansara? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The cycle of suffering and rebirth
6. Retell the three most important events of "Sansara" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Over many years Siddhartha grows wealthy, gambles, drinks, and becomes greedy and weary—like the childlike people. Kamala tells him she wishes to learn about Gotama. After a dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage, Siddhartha feels disgust at his life and leaves the city without a word. Kamala, pregnant with his child, frees her bird.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Sansara”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Sansara” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.” What does “gambled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: gambled: played games of chance for money.
10. Reread: “Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.” What does “castaway” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: castaway: a person left stranded after a shipwreck.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Sansara” suggest about the cycle of desire? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the cycle of desire? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10): The dream that wakes him. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Sansara”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Over many years Siddhartha grows wealthy, gambles, drinks, and becomes greedy and weary—like the childlike people. Kamala tells him she wishes to learn about Gotama. After a dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage, Siddhartha feels disgust at his life and leaves the city without a…
6. How does “Sansara” build on “With the Childlike People”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on” (Sansara, paragraph 6): Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. On structure: Years pass in summary; Siddhartha slowly takes on the habits he despised:

gambling, wine, greed, fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly” (Sansara, paragraph 17): Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the dead songbird symbolize?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10): The dream that wakes him. On tone / mood: Weary and disgusted; the prose itself becomes heavy with lists of pleasures. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on” (Sansara, paragraph 6): Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly” (Sansara, paragraph 17): Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10): The dream that wakes him. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Sansara” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the cycle of desire? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on” (Sansara, paragraph 6): Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Sansara”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly” (Sansara, paragraph 17): Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10): The dream that wakes him. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on” (Sansara, paragraph 6): Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is

Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Sansara” treats the cycle of desire with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly” (Sansara, paragraph 17): Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “By the River” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt” (Sansara, paragraph 10): The dream that wakes him. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cycle of desire? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “He was a feared gambler, few dared to take him on” (Sansara, paragraph 6): Gambling shows how far he has fallen into the game of the world. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The songbird in the golden cage symbolizes Siddhartha's spirit, silenced by the comfortable prison of wealth. Useful evidence: “She opened the door of the cage, took the bird out and let it fly” (Sansara, paragraph 17): Kamala's response to his disappearance: she understands. Theme link: the senses, pursued without love, become a cycle of craving: this is Sansara. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes a ferryman
   B. He becomes poor
   C. He becomes greedy and weary
   D. He becomes a holy man
2. What does Siddhartha dream about?
   A. Kamala's songbird dead in its cage
   B. His father's house
   C. A river in flood
   D. Govinda dying
3. How does Siddhartha leave the city?
   A. With a farewell feast
   B. On a ship
   C. Suddenly, without a word
   D. With Kamala
4. What does Kamala do after he leaves?
   A. Follows him
   B. Burns her garden
   C. Frees her songbird
   D. Marries Kamaswami
5. What is Sansara?
   A. A city
   B. The cycle of suffering and rebirth
   C. A song
   D. A river
6. In the line “Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.”, what does “gambled” most nearly mean?
   A. in a disrespectful jeering manner
   B. played games of chance for money
   C. a person left stranded after a shipwreck
   D. showing clearly
7. In the line “Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.”, what does “castaway” most nearly mean?
   A. a person left stranded after a shipwreck
   B. played games of chance for money

C. showing clearly

D. in a disrespectful jeering manner

Answer key: 1. C (He becomes greedy and weary); 2. A (Kamala's songbird dead in its cage); 3. C (Suddenly, without a word); 4. C (Frees her songbird); 5. B (The cycle of suffering and rebirth); 6. B (played games of chance for money); 7. A (a person left stranded after a shipwreck)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Sansara," how does Hesse show the cycle of desire? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Sansara, how does Hesse develop the idea of the cycle of desire? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Sansara (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the cycle of desire. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Sansara suggests about the cycle of desire. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Sansara to complicate the reader's understanding of the cycle of desire. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Sansara within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the cycle of desire responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Sansara alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the cycle of desire follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Sansara and its treatment of the cycle of desire. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Sansara as evidence for a larger claim about the cycle of desire in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Sansara as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the cycle of desire. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “demonstrating” most nearly mean?

   A. surrounded

   B. chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food

   C. worthy of reliance or trust

   D. showing clearly

2. *Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness. Worthless, so it seemed to him, worthless and pointless was the way he had been going through life; nothing which was alive, nothing which was in some way delicious or worth keeping he had left in his hands. Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Sansara”?

   A. The teacher and the teaching

   B. Detachment among the childlike people

   C. Learning from the river

   D. The cycle of desire

SAT key: 1. D (showing clearly); 2. D (The cycle of desire)

Lesson 9: By the River

Focus: despair and renewal by the river

Content note (suicidal intent): At the river Siddhartha intends to end his life. Use the safe-messaging script; the quiz item asks what his despair leads him toward.
Student preview: Siddhartha feels deep despair and thinks about ending his life. If this is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor.
Suggested language: "What stops Siddhartha, and what does he feel afterward?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha reaches the river and, sick of himself, leans to drown. From deep within comes the sacred word Om, and he falls into a deep sleep under a coconut tree. He wakes renewed; Govinda, now a monk, has watched over him without recognizing him. Siddhartha reflects that he had to experience despair to learn its emptiness, and decides to stay by the river.

Background: Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality.

Significance: Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the search for the self because.... Content note before we start: Siddhartha feels deep despair and thinks about ending his life. If this is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the search for the self because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: rejuvenated — made young or fresh again; ointments — perfumed oils and creams; unlearn — to forget a habit or way of thinking; sobering — cause to become sober; vomiting — eject the contents of the stomach through the mouth. “rejuvenated”: re- "again" + Latin juvenis "young" + -ate. “vomiting”: From Latin vomitare, frequentative of vomere "to spew forth." (Not from mittere "to send.")
Words: rejuvenated: made young or fresh again · ointments: perfumed oils and creams · unlearn: to forget a habit or way of thinking · sobering: cause to become sober · vomiting: eject the contents of the stomach through the mouth

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality. Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol. Characterization: Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him. Structure: Despair, sleep, awakening: the chapter repeats the structure of "Awakening," now as rebirth from despair. Irony: Govinda, now a monk, watches over the sleeping stranger and does not recognize him. Watch for the river: the place of attempted death becomes the place of rebirth.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22). The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. That is characterization at work: Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him.

> *Now, Siddhartha smiled (By the River, paragraph 22)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22). The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. That is characterization at work: Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A sponge absorbs until full: he is saturated with worldly life. Expected link: the river, a place of death, becomes a place of new life. Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self? Expected: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. (Simile for the saturation of his worldly life.)

> *Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full (By the River, paragraph 1)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A sponge absorbs until full: he is saturated with worldly life. Expected link: the river, a place of death, becomes a place of new life.
Ask: How does this line connect to the search for the self?
Expected answer: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. (Simile for the saturation of his worldly life.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and renewal by the river? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. When the text says "Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full" (By the River, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Full of Sansara "like a sponge sucks up water until it is full," he wants to die, but after the Om and his sleep "Siddhartha smiled," and he judges even his years in the city as a necessary part of the path.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and renewal by the river? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))
Exemplar: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. When the text says "Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full" (By the River, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Full of Sansara "like a sponge sucks up water until it is full," he wants to die, but after the Om and his sleep "Siddhartha smiled," and he judges even his years in the city as a necessary part of the path.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself? Content note: this chapter includes a suicide attempt. Follow the content note's guidance; keep the focus on how Hesse uses the scene.
Anchor question: Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?
Facilitation: Content note: this chapter includes a suicide attempt. Follow the content note's guidance; keep the focus on how Hesse uses the scene.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and renewal by the river? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. ("Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full", By the River, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and renewal by the river? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. ("Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full", By the River, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes despair and renewal by the river. Key takeaway: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him.
- **Structure:** Despair, sleep, awakening: the chapter repeats the structure of "Awakening," now as rebirth from despair.
- **Irony:** Govinda, now a monk, watches over the sleeping stranger and does not recognize him.

Themes and how they develop

- **the search for the self:** Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him.

Symbols and motifs

- **the river:** the place of attempted death becomes the place of rebirth.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full" (By the River, paragraph 1) Simile for the saturation of his worldly life.
- "Now, Siddhartha smiled" (By the River, paragraph 22) The turn after Om; his first smile since the city.
- "I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money" (By the River, paragraph 42) His summary of the detour.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth.
Evidence: "Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full" (By the River, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: Full of Sansara "like a sponge sucks up water until it is full," he wants to die, but after the Om and his sleep "Siddhartha smiled," and he judges even his years in the city as a necessary part of the path.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
rejuvenated (verb)	made young or fresh again	*Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!*	"rejuvenated": re- "again" + Latin juvenis "young" + -ate. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/rejuvenate)
ointments (noun)	perfumed oils and creams	*There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unlearn (verb)	to forget a habit or way of thinking	*I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sobering (verb)	cause to become sober	*What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vomiting (verb)	eject the contents of the stomach through the mouth	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	"vomiting": From Latin vomitare, frequentative of vomere "to spew forth." (Not from mittere "to send.")

			(Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/vomit)
penitents (noun)	people who punish themselves for their sins	*But as a young man, I followed the penitents, lived in the forest, suffered of heat and frost, learned to hunger, taught my body to become dead.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
smashing (noun)	breaking into pieces	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wrestled (verb)	combat to overcome an opposing tendency or force	*Was this not his self, his small, frightened, and proud self, he had wrestled with for so many years, which had defeated him again and again, which was back again after every killing, prohibited joy, felt fear?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
annihilate (verb)	to destroy completely	*There was nothing left for him, except to annihilate himself, except to smash the failure into which he had shaped his life, to throw it away, before the feet of mockingly laughing gods.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
collapsed (verb)	break down, literally or metaphorically	*By the foot of the coconut tree, Siddhartha collapsed, struck down by tiredness, mumbling Om, placed his head on the root of the tree and fell into a deep sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Ending his life in the water

2. What stops him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The word Om rising within
3. Who watches over him while he sleeps? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Govinda
4. Does Govinda recognize him at first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: No
5. What does Siddhartha decide? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To stay by the river
6. Retell the three most important events of "By the River" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha reaches the river and, sick of himself, leans to drown. From deep within comes the sacred word Om, and he falls into a deep sleep under a coconut tree. He wakes renewed; Govinda, now a monk, has watched over him without recognizing him. Siddhartha reflects that he had to experience despair to learn its emptiness, and decides to stay by the river.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "By the River"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "By the River" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!" What does "rejuvenated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: rejuvenated: made young or fresh again.
10. Reread: "There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth." What does "ointments" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: ointments: perfumed oils and creams.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "By the River" suggest about despair and renewal by the river? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about despair and renewal by the river? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: "Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full" (By the River, paragraph 1): Simile for the saturation of his worldly life. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "Siddhartha was deeply shocked.", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “By the River”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha reaches the river and, sick of himself, leans to drown. From deep within comes the sacred word Om, and he falls into a deep sleep under a coconut tree. He wakes renewed; Govinda, now a monk, has watched over him without recognizing him. Siddhartha reflects that he had to experience…
6. How does “By the River” build on “Sansara”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22): The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. On structure: Despair, sleep, awakening: the chapter repeats the structure of "Awakening," now as rebirth from despair. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money” (By the River, paragraph 42): His summary of the detour. On characterization: Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the unity of all things? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full” (By the River, paragraph 1): Simile for the saturation of his worldly life. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22): The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money” (By the River, paragraph 42): His summary of the detour. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full” (By the River, paragraph 1): Simile for the saturation of his worldly life. On characterization: Disgusted with himself, Siddhartha walks into the forest and leans over the river to drown himself; the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “By the River” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about despair and renewal by the river? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22): The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “By the River”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money” (By the River, paragraph 42): His summary of the detour. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the river and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full” (By the River, paragraph 1):

Simile for the saturation of his worldly life. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22): The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “By the River” treats despair and renewal by the river with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money” (By the River, paragraph 42): His summary of the detour. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “The Ferryman” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Deeply, he had been entangled in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full” (By the River, paragraph 1): Simile for the saturation of his worldly life. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about despair and renewal by the river? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “Now, Siddhartha smiled” (By the River, paragraph 22): The turn after Om; his first smile since the city. Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's despair at the river becomes the condition for his rebirth. Useful evidence: “I went and learned the art of love with Kamala, learned trading with Kamaswami, piled up money, wasted money” (By the River, paragraph 42): His summary of the detour.

Theme link: Siddhartha sees that he had to go through folly to kill the proud Brahmin and Samana within him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river?
   A. Crossing it
   B. Fishing
   C. Bathing
   D. Ending his life in the water
2. What stops him?
   A. A child
   B. A shout from Govinda
   C. The word Om rising within
   D. A storm
3. Who watches over him while he sleeps?
   A. Vasudeva
   B. Kamaswami
   C. Govinda
   D. Kamala
4. Does Govinda recognize him at first?
   A. Only by voice
   B. Only by his clothes
   C. No
   D. Yes immediately
5. What does Siddhartha decide?
   A. To stay by the river
   B. To return to the city
   C. To join the monks
   D. To go home
6. In the line “Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!”, what does “rejuvenated” most nearly mean?
   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking

B. made young or fresh again

C. perfumed oils and creams

D. cause to become sober

7. In the line “There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.”, what does “ointments” most nearly mean?

A. to forget a habit or way of thinking

B. cause to become sober

C. perfumed oils and creams

D. made young or fresh again

Answer key: 1. D (Ending his life in the water); 2. C (The word Om rising within); 3. C (Govinda); 4. C (No); 5. A (To stay by the river); 6. B (made young or fresh again); 7. C (perfumed oils and creams)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “By the River,” how does Hesse show despair and renewal by the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In By the River, how does Hesse develop the idea of despair and renewal by the river? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of By the River (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of despair and renewal by the river. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what By the River suggests about despair and renewal by the river. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in By the River to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and

renewal by the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate By the River within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and renewal by the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read By the River alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and renewal by the river follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to By the River and its treatment of despair and renewal by the river. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads By the River as evidence for a larger claim about despair and renewal by the river in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads By the River as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and renewal by the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “unlearn” most nearly mean?

   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking

   B. to destroy completely

   C. break down, literally or metaphorically

   D. combat to overcome an opposing tendency or force

2. *Siddhartha was deeply shocked. So this was how things were with him, so doomed was he, so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body! What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “By the River”?

   A. Awakening to the world

   B. Hearing the many voices

C. Entering the city and learning love

D. Despair and renewal by the river

SAT key: 1. A (to forget a habit or way of thinking); 2. D (Despair and renewal by the river)

Lesson 10: The Ferryman

Focus: learning from the river

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha becomes Vasudeva's assistant. Vasudeva, a simple and attentive listener, teaches him to listen to the river, which shows that there is no such thing as time—the river is everywhere at once. Years pass peacefully. Gotama's monks pass by, carrying news that the Buddha is dying, and Kamala travels with her son to see him; she is bitten by a snake, recognizes Siddhartha at the ferry, and dies in his arms. Siddhartha keeps their son.

Background: The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice.

Significance: The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *What does the river teach that no person could? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the river and time because....*
> **Prompt:** What does the river teach that no person could?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the river and time because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: obstructing — blocking; precocious — too grown-up for one's age; ferried — carried across water by boat; oarsman — someone who rows a boat; wondrously — extremely well. "ferried": From Old English ferian "to carry, transport," a Germanic word related to fare. (Not from Latin ferre.)*
> **Words:** obstructing: blocking · precocious: too grown-up for one's age · ferried: carried across water by boat · oarsman: someone who rows a boat · wondrously: extremely well

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice. The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test. Characterization: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything. Imagery: The river's surface, bubbles, colours, and above all its voices. Plot: Years later Kamala, now a Buddhist follower, comes with her son to see the dying Buddha; she is bitten by a snake and dies in Siddhartha's arms; the boy is Siddhartha's son. Watch for the river: The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "By this river I want to stay, thought Siddhartha, it is the same which" (The Ferryman, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2). The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything.

> *Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it* (The Ferryman, paragraph 2)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2). The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The list of places shows the river is one thing in many places at once; the lesson is that time is unreal. Expected link: the river and time. Ask: How does this line connect to the river and time? Expected: The river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. (The river's lesson about time.)

> *that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once* (The Ferryman, paragraph 34)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The list of places shows the river is one thing in many places at once; the lesson is that time is unreal. Expected link: the river and time.
Ask: How does this line connect to the river and time?
Expected answer: The river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. (The river's lesson about time.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning from the river? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. When the text says “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35), it shows this directly. He learns that "the river is everywhere at once," and concludes, "Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is," so his past selves are not lost but present.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning from the river? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. When the text says “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35), it shows this directly. He learns that "the river is everywhere at once," and concludes, "Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is," so his past selves are not lost but present.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does the river teach that no person could? Ask: what does it mean to live "only in the present"? Is it possible?

Anchor question: What does the river teach that no person could?

Facilitation: Ask: what does it mean to live "only in the present"? Is it possible?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning from the river? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. ("Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present", The Ferryman, paragraph 35). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning from the river? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. ("Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present", The Ferryman, paragraph 35). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes learning from the river. Key takeaway: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything.
- **Imagery:** The river's surface, bubbles, colours, and above all its voices.
- **Plot:** Years later Kamala, now a Buddhist follower, comes with her son to see the dying Buddha; she is bitten by a snake and dies in Siddhartha's arms; the boy is Siddhartha's son.

Themes and how they develop

- **the river and time:** the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present.

Symbols and motifs

- **the river:** The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "By this river I want to stay, thought Siddhartha, it is the same which" (The Ferryman, paragraph 1).
- **teachers and teachings:** Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "and it told him: Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it! Oh yes, he wanted to learn from it, he" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2) The inner voice that makes him a ferryman.
- "that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once" (The Ferryman, paragraph 34) The river's lesson about time.
- "Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present" (The Ferryman, paragraph 35) Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once.
Evidence: "Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present" (The Ferryman, paragraph 35)
Reasoning: He learns that "the river is everywhere at once," and concludes, "Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is," so his past selves are not lost but present.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
obstructing (verb)	blocking	*They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
precocious (adjective)	too grown-up for one's age	*They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ferried (verb)	carried across water by boat	*Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*	"ferried": From Old English ferian "to carry, transport," a Germanic word related to fare. (Not from Latin ferre.) (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/ferry)
oarsman (noun)	someone who rows a boat	*The rich and elegant Siddhartha is becoming an oarsman's servant, the learned Brahmin Siddhartha becomes a ferryman: this has also been told to you by the river.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wondrously (adverb)	extremely well	*He looked up and first saw the boy's face, which wondrously reminded him of something, like a warning*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		to remember something he had forgotten.	
birthplace (noun)	the place where someone was born	*Listening carefully, he let everything enter his mind, birthplace and childhood, all that learning, all that searching, all joy, all distress.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
singsong (noun)	a regular and monotonous rising and falling intonation	*And with that singsong, the boy became calm, was only now and then uttering a sob and fell asleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oneness (noun)	the quality of being united into one	*A lot it has told me, deeply it has filled me with the healing thought, with the thought of oneness."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chewing (verb)	chew (food); to bite and grind with the teeth	*She, Kamala herself, had also become tired, and while the boy was chewing a banana, she crouched down on the ground, closed her eyes a bit, and rested.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
floating (adjective)	drifting on water	*Bright pearls he saw rising from the deep, quiet bubbles of air floating on the reflecting surface, the blue of the sky being depicted in it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the river teach that no person could?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Vasudeva's
2. What is Vasudeva's greatest skill? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Listening

3. What does the river teach about time? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: That time does not truly exist
4. How is Kamala hurt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She is bitten by a snake
5. Who stays with Siddhartha after Kamala dies? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Their son
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Ferryman" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha becomes Vasudeva's assistant. Vasudeva, a simple and attentive listener, teaches him to listen to the river, which shows that there is no such thing as time—the river is everywhere at once. Years pass peacefully. Gotama's monks pass by, carrying news that the Buddha is dying, and Kamala travels with her son to see him; she is bitten by a snake, recognizes Siddhartha at the ferry, and…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Ferryman"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Ferryman" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle." What does "obstructing" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: obstructing: blocking.
10. Reread: "They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them." What does "precocious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: precocious: too grown-up for one's age.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Ferryman" suggest about learning from the river? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about learning from the river? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: "Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2): The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. On characterization: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ""Now I recognise you,"", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “The Ferryman”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha becomes Vasudeva's assistant. Vasudeva, a simple and attentive listener, teaches him to listen to the river, which shows that there is no such thing as time—the river is everywhere at once. Years pass peacefully. Gotama's monks pass by, carrying news that the Buddha is dying, and Kamala…
6. How does “The Ferryman” build on “By the River”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once” (The Ferryman, paragraph 34): The river's lesson about time. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35): Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion. On characterization: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the river teach that no person could?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the river and time? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it” (The Ferryman, paragraph 2): The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once” (The Ferryman, paragraph 34): The river's lesson about time. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35): Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it” (The Ferryman, paragraph 2): The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. On characterization: Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Ferryman” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about learning from the river? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once” (The Ferryman, paragraph 34): The river's lesson about time. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Ferryman”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35): Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to love and attachment: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it”

(The Ferryman, paragraph 2): The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once” (The Ferryman, paragraph 34): The river's lesson about time. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Ferryman” treats learning from the river with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is present” (The Ferryman, paragraph 35): Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “The Son” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Love this water! Stay near it! Learn from it” (The Ferryman, paragraph 2): The inner voice that makes him a ferryman. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about learning from the river? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “that the river is everywhere at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains, everywhere at once” (The Ferryman, paragraph 34): The river's lesson about time. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The river teaches Siddhartha that time is an illusion and that every stage of life is present at once. Useful evidence: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is,

everything has existence and is present" (The Ferryman, paragraph 35): Siddhartha's conclusion: time is illusion. Theme link: the river is "everywhere at once"; there is no time, only the present. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?
   A. Kamaswami's
   B. Gotama's
   C. Vasudeva's
   D. Govinda's
2. What is Vasudeva's greatest skill?
   A. Preaching
   B. Listening
   C. Bargaining
   D. Fighting
3. What does the river teach about time?
   A. That time is cruel
   B. That time is short
   C. That time does not truly exist
   D. That time is money
4. How is Kamala hurt?
   A. She falls in the river
   B. She is bitten by a snake
   C. She catches fever
   D. She is robbed
5. Who stays with Siddhartha after Kamala dies?
   A. Their son
   B. Kamaswami
   C. Gotama
   D. Govinda

6. In the line “They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman’s job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.”, what does “obstructing” most nearly mean?
   A. someone who rows a boat
   B. carried across water by boat
   C. too grown-up for one's age
   D. blocking
7. In the line “They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.”, what does “precocious” most nearly mean?
   A. blocking
   B. someone who rows a boat
   C. carried across water by boat
   D. too grown-up for one's age

Answer key: 1. C (Vasudeva's); 2. B (Listening); 3. C (That time does not truly exist); 4. B (She is bitten by a snake); 5. A (Their son); 6. D (blocking); 7. D (too grown-up for one's age)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Ferryman,” how does Hesse show learning from the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In The Ferryman, how does Hesse develop the idea of learning from the river? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of The Ferryman (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of learning from the river. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what The Ferryman suggests about learning from the river. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each

(including the chapter's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in The Ferryman to complicate the reader's understanding of learning from the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate The Ferryman within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning from the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read The Ferryman alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning from the river follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Ferryman and its treatment of learning from the river. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Ferryman as evidence for a larger claim about learning from the river in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Ferryman as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning from the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ferried” most nearly mean?

   A. drifting on water

   B. the quality of being united into one

   C. carried across water by boat

   D. chew (food); to bite and grind with the teeth

2. *"Now I recognise you," he finally said. "At one time, you've slept in my hut, this was a long time ago, possibly more than twenty years ago, and you've been ferried across the river by me, and we parted like good friends. Haven't you been a Samana? I can't think of your name any more."*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Ferryman"?

A. Self-denial as a path

B. Awakening to the world

C. Learning from the river

D. The pain of a father's love

SAT key: 1. C (carried across water by boat); 2. C (Learning from the river)

Lesson 11: The Son

Focus: the pain of a father's love

Content note (family conflict): Siddhartha's son rejects and robs him. The vocabulary list no longer includes “fornicator”.
Student preview: Siddhartha's son rebels against him.
Suggested language: “Why can't Siddhartha teach his son what he learned?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha's spoiled son, raised in wealth, despises the ferry life and his father's gentleness. Vasudeva advises letting the boy return to the world, but Siddhartha cannot let go. The son finally runs away, stealing the ferry money. Siddhartha follows to the city and stops at Kamala's old garden, realizing he must not pursue him. Vasudeva brings him home.

Background: This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves.

Significance: Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and attachment because.... Content note before we start: Siddhartha's son rebels against him.
Prompt: How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and attachment because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a father's love becomes his "final wound."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: reciprocate — to return (a feeling); ranting — loud and angry; soiling — making dirty; burdening — weight down with a load; exuberant — joyously unrestrained.
Words: reciprocate: to return (a feeling) · ranting: loud and angry · soiling: making dirty · burdening: weight down with a load · exuberant: joyously unrestrained

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves. Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike. Characterization: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go. Irony: Siddhartha, who once could not love, now loves foolishly, like the childlike people. Dialogue: Vasudeva's questions ask Siddhartha to see his own youth in the boy. Watch for the son: the boy is Siddhartha's younger self returned: proud, restless, unwilling to be taught. When he runs away, Siddhartha is in his own father's place.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You cannot love" (The Son, paragraph 17). Kamala's old words haunt him. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go.

> *You cannot love (The Son, paragraph 17)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You cannot love" (The Son, paragraph 17). Kamala's old words haunt him. That is characterization at work: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Vasudeva's question implies that no one can be spared their own path; Siddhartha made his own mistakes and learned from them, so protecting his son would take away the only way to learn. Expected link: love and attachment, and the novel's claim about teaching versus experience. Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment? Expected: A father's love becomes his "final wound." (Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way.)

> *Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too (The Son, paragraph 14)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Vasudeva's question implies that no one can be spared their own path; Siddhartha made his own mistakes and learned from them, so protecting his son would take away the only way to learn. Expected link: love and attachment, and the novel's claim about teaching versus experience.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and attachment?
Expected answer: A father's love becomes his "final wound." (Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pain of a father's love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. When the text says "Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too" (The Son, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. Vasudeva asks whether he committed "foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too," reminding him that he, too, left his father.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pain of a father's love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. When the text says "Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too" (The Son, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. Vasudeva asks whether he committed "foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too," reminding him that he, too, left his father.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's? Ask: should Siddhartha let his son go? Compare with Chapter I.

Anchor question: How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?

Facilitation: Ask: should Siddhartha let his son go? Compare with Chapter I.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pain of a father's love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. ("Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too", The Son, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pain of a father's love? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. ("Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too", The Son, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the pain of a father's love. Key takeaway: a father's love becomes his "final wound."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go.
- **Irony:** Siddhartha, who once could not love, now loves foolishly, like the childlike people.
- **Dialogue:** Vasudeva's questions ask Siddhartha to see his own youth in the boy.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and attachment:** a father's love becomes his "final wound."

Symbols and motifs

- **the son:** the boy is Siddhartha's younger self returned: proud, restless, unwilling to be taught. When he runs away, Siddhartha is in his own father's place.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too" (The Son, paragraph 14) Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way.
- "You cannot love" (The Son, paragraph 17) Kamala's old words haunt him.
- "now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person" (The Son, paragraph 17) His transformation.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment.
Evidence: "Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too" (The Son, paragraph 14)
Reasoning: Vasudeva asks whether he committed "foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too," reminding him that he, too, left his father.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
reciprocate (verb)	to return (a feeling)	*For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ranting (adjective)	loud and angry	*"I must follow him," said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
soiling (verb)	making dirty	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
burdening (verb)	weight down with a load	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*Won't he become exuberant, won't he lose himself to pleasure and power, won't he repeat all of his father's mistakes, won't he perhaps get entirely lost in Sansara?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thumped (verb)	hit hard with a dull sound	*But the boy did not leave the hut, in stubborn disobedience and rage he stayed where he was, thumped on the ground with his feet, clenched his fists, and screamed in a powerful outburst his hatred and contempt into his father's face.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
humiliate (verb)	cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of	*Through all this, the son let him commit his foolish acts, let him court for his affection, let him humiliate himself every day by giving in to his moods.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
warnings (noun)	a message informing of danger	*Were his father's religious devotion, his teachers warnings, his own knowledge, his own search able to keep him safe?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

enriched (verb)	make better or improve in quality	*Now he too felt, late, once in his lifetime, this strongest and strangest of all passions, suffered from it, suffered miserably, and was nevertheless in bliss, was nevertheless renewed in one respect, enriched by one thing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
admonition (noun)	cautionary advice about something imminent (especially imminent danger or other unpleasantness)	*By means of teachings, prayer, admonition?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does the son treat Siddhartha? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: With contempt
2. What does Vasudeva advise? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Let the boy go into the world
3. What does the son steal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The ferry money
4. Where does Siddhartha go in pursuit? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To the city and Kamala's old garden
5. What is ironic about Siddhartha's pain? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He now feels the attachment he once called childlike
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Son” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha's spoiled son, raised in wealth, despises the ferry life and his father's gentleness. Vasudeva advises letting the boy return to the world, but Siddhartha cannot let go. The son finally runs away, stealing the ferry money. Siddhartha follows to the city and stops at Kamala's old garden, realizing he must not pursue him. Vasudeva brings him home.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Son”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

8. Where and when does “The Son” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.” What does “reciprocate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: reciprocate: to return (a feeling).
10. Reread: ““I must follow him,” said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.” What does “ranting” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: ranting: loud and angry.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Son” suggest about the pain of a father's love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the pain of a father's love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too” (The Son, paragraph 14): Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way. On irony: Siddhartha, who once could not love, now loves foolishly, like the childlike people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Son”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Siddhartha's spoiled son, raised in wealth, despises the ferry life and his father's gentleness. Vasudeva advises letting the boy return to the world, but Siddhartha cannot let go. The son finally runs away, stealing the ferry money. Siddhartha follows to the city and stops at Kamala's old garden,…
6. How does “The Son” build on “The Ferryman”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17): Kamala's old words haunt him. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person” (The Son, paragraph 17): His transformation. On characterization: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with love and attachment? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too” (The Son, paragraph 14): Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17): Kamala's old words haunt him. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person” (The Son, paragraph 17): His transformation. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too” (The Son, paragraph 14): Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way. On characterization: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and

resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “The Son” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the pain of a father's love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17): Kamala's old words haunt him. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “The Son”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person” (The Son, paragraph 17): His transformation. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the search for self-knowledge: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too” (The Son, paragraph 14): Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17): Kamala's old words haunt him. On characterization: Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Son” treats the pain of a father's love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person” (The Son, paragraph 17): His transformation. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Om” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “Would you actually believe that you had committed your foolish acts in order to spare your son from committing them too” (The Son, paragraph 14): Vasudeva's question: each must find his own way. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the pain of a father's love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17): Kamala's old words haunt him. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's love for his son repeats his father's love for him, showing the cycle of attachment. Useful evidence: “now he, Siddhartha, had also become completely a childlike person” (The Son, paragraph 17): His transformation. Theme link: a father's love becomes his "final wound." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does the son treat Siddhartha?
   A. With contempt
   B. With fear
   C. With silence
   D. With love
2. What does Vasudeva advise?
   A. Punish him
   B. Let the boy go into the world
   C. Lock him up

D. Send him to monks

3. What does the son steal?
   A. Food
   B. A boat only
   C. Kamala's ring
   D. The ferry money
4. Where does Siddhartha go in pursuit?
   A. To the city and Kamala's old garden
   B. To his father's house
   C. To the mountains
   D. To Gotama's grove
5. What is ironic about Siddhartha's pain?
   A. He forgets the boy
   B. He becomes rich
   C. He now feels the attachment he once called childlike
   D. He is happy
6. In the line “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.”, what does “reciprocate” most nearly mean?
   A. to return (a feeling)
   B. making dirty
   C. loud and angry
   D. weight down with a load
7. In the line ““I must follow him,” said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.”, what does “ranting” most nearly mean?
   A. loud and angry
   B. weight down with a load
   C. to return (a feeling)
   D. making dirty

Answer key: 1. A (With contempt); 2. B (Let the boy go into the world); 3. D (The ferry money); 4. A (To the city and Kamala's old garden); 5. C (He now feels the attachment he once called childlike); 6. A (to return (a feeling)); 7. A (loud and angry)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Son,” how does Hesse show the pain of a father's love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Son, how does Hesse develop the idea of the pain of a father's love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of The Son (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the pain of a father's love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what The Son suggests about the pain of a father's love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son to complicate the reader's understanding of the pain of a father's love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate The Son within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the pain of a father's love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read The Son alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the pain of a father's love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Son and its treatment of the pain of a father's love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Son as evidence for a larger claim about the pain of a father's love in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Son as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the pain of a father's love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “soiling” most nearly mean?

   A. cautionary advice about something imminent (especially imminent danger or other unpleasantness)

   B. make better or improve in quality

   C. making dirty

   D. a message informing of danger

2. *For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it. For long months, Vasudeva waited, watching, waited and said nothing. One day, when Siddhartha the younger had once again tormented his father very much with spite and an unsteadiness in his wishes and had broken both of his rice bowls, Vasudeva took in the evening his friend aside and talked to him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Son”?

   A. The pain of a father's love

   B. Entering the city and learning love

   C. Self-denial as a path

   D. Hearing the many voices

SAT key: 1. C (making dirty); 2. A (The pain of a father's love)

Lesson 12: Om

Focus: hearing the many voices

Teacher only · spoilers

Still aching for his son, Siddhartha sees his reflection resemble his own father and understands the circle of suffering. He confesses everything to Vasudeva, who leads him to listen; the river's voices—joy and sorrow, good and evil—blend into one word, Om. Siddhartha achieves serenity. Vasudeva, his work done, walks into the forest to die.

Background: Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism.

Significance: The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to unity of opposites because....
Prompt: What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to unity of opposites because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: all voices are one.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: blossomed — developed; grew and flourished; fateful — decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end; ferryboat — a boat that carries people across water; ripened — cause to ripen or develop fully; embarrassing — cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious. "ferryboat": ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat.
Words: blossomed: developed; grew and flourished · fateful: decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end · ferryboat: a boat that carries people across water · ripened: cause to ripen or develop fully · embarrassing: cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism. The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master. Structure: The climax: Siddhartha listens to the river and hears all voices become Om. Characterization: Vasudeva, his work done, leaves for the forest. Imagery: Voices of joy, grief, longing, death blend into one. Watch for Om: the syllable that saved him at the river in Chapter VII returns as the sum of all voices: the end of his search is the sound he began with as a Brahmin's son.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness" (Om, paragraph 3). Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. That is structure at work: The climax: Siddhartha listens to the river and hears all voices become Om.

> *harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness (Om, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness" (Om, paragraph 3). Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. That is structure at work: The climax: Siddhartha listens to the river and hears all voices become Om.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Thousand voices" become "a single word": joy and grief, life and death are heard together. Om is "the perfection," not because suffering stops but because it is part of the whole. Expected link: unity of opposites, and the river as teacher. Ask: How does this line connect to unity of opposites? Expected: All voices are one. (The climax.)

> *then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection (Om, paragraph 17)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Thousand voices" become "a single word": joy and grief, life and death are heard together. Om is "the perfection," not because suffering stops but because it is part of the whole. Expected link: unity of opposites, and the river as teacher.
Ask: How does this line connect to unity of opposites?
Expected answer: All voices are one. (The climax.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about hearing the many voices? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. When the text says “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Only after his "final wound" does "the great song of the thousand voices" consist "of a single word, which was Om: the perfection," and he sees the same "oneness" in Vasudeva's smiling face.

Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about hearing the many voices? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. When the text says “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Only after his "final wound" does "the great song of the thousand voices" consist "of a single word, which was Om: the perfection," and he sees the same "oneness" in Vasudeva's smiling face.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together? Ask: how does Siddhartha's enlightenment compare with the Buddha's?

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Facilitation: Ask: how does Siddhartha's enlightenment compare with the Buddha's?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about hearing the many voices? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. ("then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection", Om, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about hearing the many voices? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. ("then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection", Om, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes hearing the many voices. Key takeaway: all voices are one.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The climax: Siddhartha listens to the river and hears all voices become Om.
- **Characterization:** Vasudeva, his work done, leaves for the forest.
- **Imagery:** Voices of joy, grief, longing, death blend into one.
- **Point of view:** The narration slows and expands into one long listening; the reader hears the voices in the order Siddhartha does.

Themes and how they develop

- **unity of opposites:** all voices are one.

Symbols and motifs

- **Om:** the syllable that saved him at the river in Chapter VII returns as the sum of all voices: the end of his search is the sound he began with as a Brahmin's son.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection" (Om, paragraph 17) The climax.
- "harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness" (Om, paragraph 3) Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face.
- "he understood them, he understood" (Om, paragraph 2) His new compassion for ordinary people.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one.
Evidence: "then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection" (Om, paragraph 17)
Reasoning: Only after his "final wound" does "the great song of the thousand voices" consist "of a single word, which was Om: the perfection," and he sees the same "oneness" in Vasudeva's smiling face.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
blossomed (verb)	developed; grew and flourished	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fateful (adjective)	decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end	*Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ferryboat (noun)	a boat that carries people across water	*He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*	"ferryboat": ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/ferry)
ripened (verb)	cause to ripen or develop fully	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
embarrassing (verb)	cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious	*He reported everything, he was able to say everything, even the most embarrassing parts, everything could be said, everything shown, everything he could tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nurtured (verb)	help develop, help grow	*But the wound still burned, longingly and bitterly Siddhartha thought of his son, nurtured his love and tenderness in his heart, allowed the pain to gnaw at him, committed all foolish acts of love.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
runaway (noun)	a person who has run away	*He presented his wound, also told how he fled today, how he ferried across the water, a childish runaway, willing to walk to the city, how the river had laughed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

resounded (verb)	ring or echo with sound	*It still resounded, full of suffering, searching, but other voices joined it, voices of joy and of suffering, good and bad voices, laughing and sad ones, a hundred voices, a thousand voices.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bathing (verb)	cleanse the entire body	*To show his wound to this listener was the same as bathing it in the river, until it had cooled and become one with the river.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
weaving (verb)	interlace by or as if by weaving	*Vasudeva was sitting in the hut and weaving a basket.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His father
2. Whom does he confess everything to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Vasudeva
3. What do all the river's voices become? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The single word Om
4. What state does Siddhartha reach? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Serenity
5. What does Vasudeva do afterward? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walks into the forest to die
6. Retell the three most important events of "Om" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Still aching for his son, Siddhartha sees his reflection resemble his own father and understands the circle of suffering. He confesses everything to Vasudeva, who leads him to listen; the river's voices—joy and sorrow, good and evil—blend into one word, Om. Siddhartha achieves serenity. Vasudeva, his work done, walks into the forest to die.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Om”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Om” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.” What does “blossomed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: blossomed: developed; grew and flourished.
10. Reread: “Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?” What does “fateful” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: fateful: decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Om” suggest about hearing the many voices? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about hearing the many voices? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17): The climax. On imagery: Voices of joy, grief, longing, death blend into one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Om”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Still aching for his son, Siddhartha sees his reflection resemble his own father and understands the circle of suffering. He confesses everything to Vasudeva, who leads him to listen; the river's voices—joy and sorrow, good and evil—blend into one word, Om. Siddhartha achieves serenity. Vasudeva,…
6. How does “Om” build on “The Son”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness” (Om, paragraph 3): Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. On structure: The climax: Siddhartha listens to the river and hears all voices become Om. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2): His new compassion for ordinary people. On characterization: Vasudeva, his work done, leaves for the forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17): The climax. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness” (Om, paragraph 3): Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2): His new compassion for ordinary people. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not

from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17): The climax. On characterization: Vasudeva, his work done, leaves for the forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Om” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about hearing the many voices? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness” (Om, paragraph 3): Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. On point of view: The narration slows and expands into one long listening; the reader hears the voices in the order Siddhartha does. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Om”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2): His new compassion for ordinary people. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17): The climax. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness” (Om, paragraph 3): Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Om” treats hearing the many voices with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2): His new compassion for ordinary people. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Govinda” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “then the great song of the thousand voices consisted of a single word, which was Om: the perfection” (Om, paragraph 17): The climax. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about hearing the many voices? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness” (Om, paragraph 3): Siddhartha's enlightenment in Vasudeva's face. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Siddhartha's enlightenment comes from listening, not from teaching: he hears every voice of life as one. Useful evidence: “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2): His new compassion for ordinary people. Theme link: all voices are one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?
   A. His father
   B. His son
   C. Govinda
   D. Gotama
2. Whom does he confess everything to?
   A. The river god
   B. Vasudeva

C. Kamala

D. Govinda

3. What do all the river's voices become?

A. Silence

B. A song of war

C. The single word Om

D. His son's voice

4. What state does Siddhartha reach?

A. Confusion

B. Anger

C. Serenity

D. Despair

5. What does Vasudeva do afterward?

A. Takes a new boat

B. Walks into the forest to die

C. Leaves for the city

D. Becomes a monk

6. In the line “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

A. a boat that carries people across water

B. cause to ripen or develop fully

C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

D. developed; grew and flourished

7. In the line “Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?”, what does “fateful” most nearly mean?

A. a boat that carries people across water

B. developed; grew and flourished

C. cause to ripen or develop fully

D. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

Answer key: 1. A (His father); 2. B (Vasudeva); 3. C (The single word Om); 4. C (Serenity); 5. B (Walks into the forest to die); 6. D (developed; grew and flourished); 7. D (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Om,” how does Hesse show hearing the many voices? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Om, how does Hesse develop the idea of hearing the many voices? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Om (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of hearing the many voices. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Om suggests about hearing the many voices. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Om to complicate the reader's understanding of hearing the many voices. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Om within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of hearing the many voices responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Om alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of hearing the many voices follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Om and its treatment of hearing the many voices. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Om as evidence for a larger claim about hearing the many voices in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Om as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of hearing the many voices. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ferryboat” most nearly mean?

   A. ring or echo with sound

   B. a boat that carries people across water

   C. interlace by or as if by weaving

   D. cleanse the entire body

2. *Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was. It was nothing but a readiness of the soul, an ability, a secret art, to think every moment, while living his life, the thought of oneness, to be able to feel and inhale the oneness. Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva’s old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Om”?

   A. Hearing the many voices

   B. Restlessness despite privilege

   C. Entering the city and learning love

   D. The pain of a father's love

SAT key: 1. B (a boat that carries people across water); 2. A (Hearing the many voices)

Lesson 13: Govinda

Focus: wisdom cannot be taught

Teacher only · spoilers

Old Govinda, still searching, comes to the ferry and asks for teaching. Siddhartha says that wisdom cannot be communicated in words, that every truth's opposite is also true, and that one must love the world. Asked to kiss Siddhartha's forehead, Govinda sees in his face a stream of countless faces and forms—the unity of all things—and bows, weeping, before his friend's smile.

Background: The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality.

Significance: The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to teaching versus experience because....
Prompt: Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to teaching versus experience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: insights — understandings; realizations; benevolently — in a kind, well-meaning way; searcher — a person who searches; bizarre — conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual; progressed — moved forward; advanced.
Words: insights: understandings; realizations · benevolently: in a kind, well-meaning way · searcher: a person who searches · bizarre: conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual · progressed: moved forward; advanced

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality. The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment. Dialogue: Siddhartha and the old Govinda talk; Siddhartha says wisdom cannot be taught. Characterization: Govinda kisses his forehead and sees all faces in Siddhartha's face. Symbolism: Govinda's vision of countless faces in Siddhartha's face (fish, newborns, murderers, gods) shows the unity Siddhartha cannot put into words; the smile he sees is like the Buddha's. Watch for the river: The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "Gotama for a gift. He heard talk of an old ferryman, who lived one day's journey away by the river, and who" (Govinda, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal" (Govinda, paragraph 7). Govinda's problem. That is dialogue at work: Siddhartha and the old Govinda talk; Siddhartha says wisdom cannot be taught.

> *Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal* (Govinda, paragraph 7)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal" (Govinda, paragraph 7). Govinda's problem. That is dialogue at work: Siddhartha and the old Govinda talk; Siddhartha says wisdom cannot be taught.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The paradox is that a book (words) argues that wisdom cannot be passed on in words. Students might answer that the novel offers an experience, not a doctrine: we live Siddhartha's life with him. Expected link: teaching versus experience. Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience? Expected: Knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. (The novel's thesis.)

> *wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness* (Govinda, paragraph 17)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The paradox is that a book (words) argues that wisdom cannot be passed on in words. Students might answer that the novel offers an experience, not a doctrine: we live Siddhartha's life with him. Expected link: teaching versus experience.
Ask: How does this line connect to teaching versus experience?
Expected answer: Knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. (The novel's thesis.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about wisdom cannot be taught? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) Exemplar: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. When the text says "wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness" (Govinda, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Siddhartha tells Govinda that "wisdom cannot be passed on" and that "searching means: having a goal," which is Govinda's obstacle; Govinda's understanding comes only when he kisses Siddhartha's forehead and sees, rather than hears.

Task: Annotate the chapter for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about wisdom cannot be taught? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.))

Exemplar: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. When the text says "wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness" (Govinda, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Siddhartha tells Govinda that "wisdom cannot be passed on" and that "searching means: having a goal," which is Govinda's obstacle; Govinda's understanding comes only when he kisses Siddhartha's forehead and sees, rather than hears.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more? Ask: is there a paradox in a novel teaching that wisdom cannot be taught?

Anchor question: Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?

Facilitation: Ask: is there a paradox in a novel teaching that wisdom cannot be taught?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about wisdom cannot be taught? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. ("wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness", Govinda, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about wisdom cannot be taught? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. ("wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness", Govinda, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes wisdom cannot be taught. Key takeaway: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Siddhartha and the old Govinda talk; Siddhartha says wisdom cannot be taught.
- **Characterization:** Govinda kisses his forehead and sees all faces in Siddhartha's face.
- **Symbolism:** Govinda's vision of countless faces in Siddhartha's face (fish, newborns, murderers, gods) shows the unity Siddhartha cannot put into words; the smile he sees is like the Buddha's.

Themes and how they develop

- **teaching versus experience:** knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot.
- **unity of opposites:** Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself."

Symbols and motifs

- **the river:** The river teaches unity, simultaneity and listening; it returns in every stage of Siddhartha's life. In this chapter: "Gotama for a gift. He heard talk of an old ferryman, who lived one day's journey away by the river, and who" (Govinda, paragraph 1).
- **teachers and teachings:** Siddhartha learns from many teachers but concludes that wisdom cannot be taught in words. In this chapter: "me to ask one more question. Do you have a teaching? Do you have a faith, or a knowledge, you follow, which" (Govinda, paragraph 14).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness" (Govinda, paragraph 17) The novel's thesis.
- "Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal" (Govinda, paragraph 7) Govinda's problem.
- "I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark" (Govinda, paragraph 26) Love of the world.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught.
Evidence: "wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness" (Govinda, paragraph 17)
Reasoning: Siddhartha tells Govinda that "wisdom cannot be passed on" and that "searching means: having a goal," which is Govinda's obstacle; Govinda's understanding comes only when he kisses Siddhartha's forehead and sees, rather than hears.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insights (noun)	understandings; realizations	*But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
benevolently (adverb)	in a kind, well-meaning way	*The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
searcher (noun)	a person who searches	*Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bizarre (adjective)	conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual	*(But secretly he thought to himself: This Siddhartha is a bizarre person, he expresses bizarre thoughts, his teachings sound foolish.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
progressed (verb)	moved forward; advanced	*It is not possible for any person to see how far another one has already progressed on his path; in the robber and dice-gambler, the Buddha is waiting; in the Brahmin, the robber is waiting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tolerance (noun)	willingness to accept others' beliefs or ways	*He commands benevolence, clemency, sympathy, tolerance, but not love; he forbade us to tie our heart in love to earthly things."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

simultaneous (adjective)	occurring or operating at the same time	*In deep meditation, there is the possibility to put time out of existence, to see all life which was, is, and will be as if it was simultaneous, and there everything is good, everything is perfect, everything is Brahman.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incarnation (noun)	a lifetime in a particular body	*It is unlikely for one of us to see the other again in this incarnation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predecessor (noun)	one who precedes you in time (as in holding a position or office)	*But most of all, I have learned here from this river and from my predecessor, the ferryman Vasudeva.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
developing (verb)	growing; changing over time	*The sinner is not on his way to become a Buddha, he is not in the process of developing, though our capacity for thinking does not know how else to picture these things.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who comes to the ferry at the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Govinda
2. What does Siddhartha say about wisdom? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: It cannot be taught in words
3. What does Siddhartha say one must do with the world? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Love it
4. What does Govinda see in Siddhartha's face? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Countless faces and forms flowing together
5. Whose smile does Siddhartha's resemble? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gotama's
6. Retell the three most important events of “Govinda” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Old Govinda, still searching, comes to the ferry and asks for teaching. Siddhartha says that wisdom cannot be communicated in words, that every truth's opposite is also true, and that one must

love the world. Asked to kiss Siddhartha's forehead, Govinda sees in his face a stream of countless faces and forms—the unity of all things—and bows, weeping, before his friend's smile.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Govinda”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Govinda” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “But haven’t you found something by yourself, though you’ve found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?” What does “insights” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: insights: understandings; realizations.
10. Reread: “The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he…” What does “benevolently” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: benevolently: in a kind, well-meaning way.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Govinda” suggest about wisdom cannot be taught? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.
2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about wisdom cannot be taught? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness” (Govinda, paragraph 17): The novel's thesis. On characterization: Govinda kisses his forehead and sees all faces in Siddhartha's face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: “You’re very good to us monks and pilgrims,…”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Govinda”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Old Govinda, still searching, comes to the ferry and asks for teaching. Siddhartha says that wisdom cannot be communicated in words, that every truth's opposite is also true, and that one must love the world. Asked to kiss Siddhartha's forehead, Govinda sees in his face a stream of countless faces…
6. How does “Govinda” build on “Om”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open,

having no goal” (Govinda, paragraph 7): Govinda's problem. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark” (Govinda, paragraph 26): Love of the world. On characterization: Govinda kisses his forehead and sees all faces in Siddhartha's face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness” (Govinda, paragraph 17): The novel's thesis. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal” (Govinda, paragraph 7): Govinda's problem. Theme link: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark” (Govinda, paragraph 26): Love of the world. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness” (Govinda, paragraph 17): The novel's thesis. On characterization: Govinda kisses his forehead and sees all faces in Siddhartha's face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Govinda” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about wisdom cannot be taught? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal” (Govinda, paragraph 7): Govinda's problem. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Govinda”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark” (Govinda, paragraph 26): Love of the world. Theme link: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness” (Govinda, paragraph 17): The novel's thesis. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal” (Govinda, paragraph 7): Govinda's problem. Theme link: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Govinda” treats wisdom cannot be taught with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2,

7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark” (Govinda, paragraph 26): Love of the world. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve experience versus teaching? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “wisdom cannot be passed on. Wisdom which a wise man tries to pass on to someone always sounds like foolishness” (Govinda, paragraph 17): The novel's thesis. Theme link: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about wisdom cannot be taught? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “Searching means: having a goal. But finding means: being free, being open, having no goal” (Govinda, paragraph 7): Govinda's problem. Theme link: Siddhartha says the world "is perfect in every moment, all sin already carries the divine forgiveness in itself." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The novel ends by claiming that wisdom must be lived, not taught. Useful evidence: “I can love a stone, Govinda, and also a tree or a piece of bark” (Govinda, paragraph 26): Love of the world. Theme link: knowledge can be taught, wisdom cannot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who comes to the ferry at the end?

   A. Govinda

   B. Gotama

   C. Siddhartha's son

D. Kamala

2. What does Siddhartha say about wisdom?
   A. It cannot be taught in words
   B. It is useless
   C. It is in books
   D. It belongs to monks
3. What does Siddhartha say one must do with the world?
   A. Escape it
   B. Love it
   C. Rule it
   D. Ignore it
4. What does Govinda see in Siddhartha's face?
   A. Fire
   B. Countless faces and forms flowing together
   C. Only an old man
   D. His own father
5. Whose smile does Siddhartha's resemble?
   A. His son's
   B. Kamala's
   C. Gotama's
   D. Vasudeva's only
6. In the line "But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?", what does "insights" most nearly mean?
   A. in a kind, well-meaning way
   B. a person who searches
   C. understandings; realizations
   D. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
7. In the line "The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.", what does "benevolently" most nearly mean?
   A. understandings; realizations
   B. in a kind, well-meaning way
   C. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
   D. a person who searches

Answer key: 1. A (Govinda); 2. A (It cannot be taught in words); 3. B (Love it); 4. B (Countless faces and forms flowing together); 5. C (Gotama's); 6. C (understandings; realizations); 7. B (in a kind, well-meaning way)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Govinda,” how does Hesse show wisdom cannot be taught? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In Govinda, how does Hesse develop the idea of wisdom cannot be taught? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Govinda (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of wisdom cannot be taught. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Govinda suggests about wisdom cannot be taught. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in Govinda to complicate the reader's understanding of wisdom cannot be taught. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Govinda within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of wisdom cannot be taught responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Govinda alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of wisdom cannot be taught follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Govinda and its treatment of wisdom cannot be taught. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Govinda as evidence for a larger claim about wisdom cannot be taught in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Govinda as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of wisdom cannot be taught. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

   As used in the text, what does the word "searcher" most nearly mean?

   A. a lifetime in a particular body

   B. one who precedes you in time (as in holding a position or office)

   C. growing; changing over time

   D. a person who searches

2. *He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us across the river. Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Govinda"?

   A. Wisdom cannot be taught

   B. Entering the city and learning love

   C. The teacher and the teaching

   D. Restlessness despite privilege

SAT key: 1. D (a person who searches); 2. A (Wisdom cannot be taught)

Whole-book test

Siddhartha: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Fasting and self-denial
   C. Warfare
   D. Trading goods
3. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a city market
   B. In a palace
   C. By the river
   D. In the grove of Jetavana
4. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. His father
   B. The Samanas
   C. Himself
   D. The Buddha
5. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Govinda
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Gotama
6. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
7. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes a ferryman

B. He becomes poor

C. He becomes greedy and weary

D. He becomes a holy man

8. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river?

A. Crossing it

B. Fishing

C. Bathing

D. Ending his life in the water

9. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?

A. Kamaswami's

B. Gotama's

C. Vasudeva's

D. Govinda's

10. How does the son treat Siddhartha?

A. With contempt

B. With fear

C. With silence

D. With love

11. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?

A. His father

B. His son

C. Govinda

D. Gotama

12. Who comes to the ferry at the end?

A. Govinda

B. Gotama

C. Siddhartha's son

D. Kamala

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the search for self-knowledge develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how experience versus teaching develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how the unity of all things develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the search for self-knowledge, experience versus teaching, the unity of all things, the river and time, love and attachment) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. B (Fasting and self-denial); 3. D (In the grove of Jetavana); 4. C (Himself); 5. B (Vasudeva); 6. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 7. C (He becomes greedy and weary); 8. D (Ending his life in the water); 9. C (Vasudeva's); 10. A (With contempt); 11. A (His father); 12. A (Govinda)

Essay assignments

Essay: The search for self-knowledge

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the search for self-knowledge. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the search for self-knowledge. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the search for self-knowledge, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the search for self-knowledge in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Experience versus teaching

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about experience versus teaching. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of experience versus teaching. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of experience versus teaching, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of experience versus teaching in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about experience versus teaching in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The unity of all things

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the unity of all things. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the unity of all things. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the unity of all things, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the unity of all things in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the unity of all things in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the unity of all things in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the unity of all things in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The river and time

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the river and time. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the river and time. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the river and time in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the river and time, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the river and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the river and time in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the river and time in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the river and time in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the river and time in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Love and attachment

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about love and attachment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and attachment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and attachment in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and attachment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of love and attachment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and attachment in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and attachment in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and attachment in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and attachment in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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